



Ninaivu

நினைவு · memory

Your family's photographs, at home.

The application guide · version 0.1.0

Ninaivu
the library

Mugil
backup

Sudar
the photo studio

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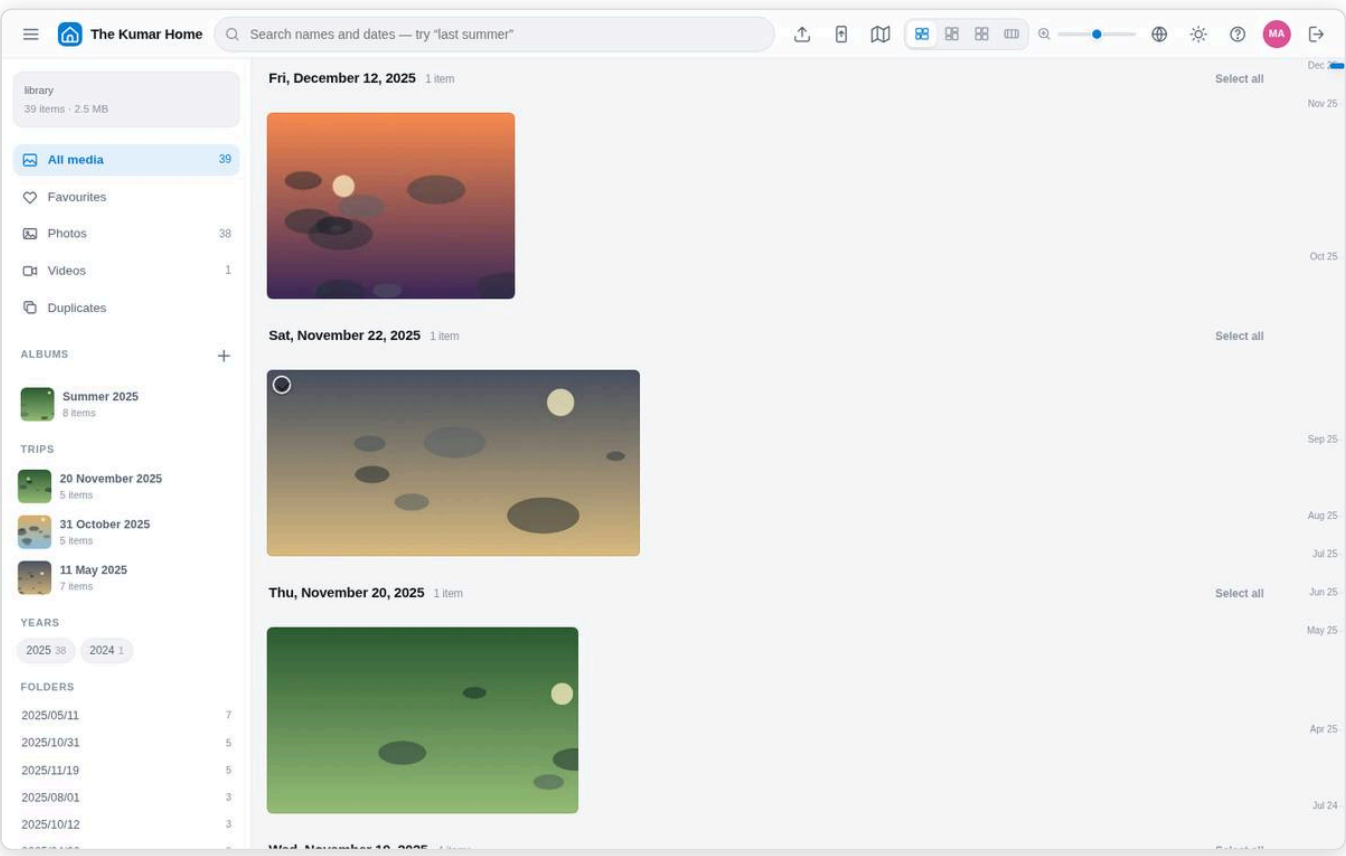
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The pictures use a generated sample library, not anybody's photographs. Everything here runs on a computer you own; nothing leaves the house unless you choose where it goes.

Ninaivu

நினைவு · *memory* — your family's photographs, at home.

Ninaivu is a private photo and video library for one household. It runs on a computer you own, indexes what is on your own disks, and gives your family what people usually leave to a cloud service: faces and names, search by description, places on a map, "on this day", a link for the grandparents, and phones that back themselves up at home. Nothing leaves the house unless you choose where it goes — and then it goes encrypted.



It has three parts, each with a name:

Ninaivu	The library: gallery, faces, search, places, albums, sharing, and the three roles
Mugil (முகில், cloud)	Backup: an encrypted copy of the library on Google Drive or another disk, and the household's phones backed up to the house
Sudar (சூடர், glow)	The photo studio: light, colour, straightening, crops and suggestions, in the browser, never changing the original

Where to start

1. Install — Windows, macOS, Docker, or a checkout. Ten minutes.
2. The first day — the folder, the household, what the scan works out by itself.
3. Family and roles — who sees what.
4. Backup — a copy outside the house, tested every week.
5. Remote access — reaching it from away.
6. AI — what runs on your machine, and what a small machine skips.
7. Troubleshooting.

Then **the guide**, everything each screen does: the family app for the household, the console for whoever runs it. Every screen, pictured: a tour of the screens.

Status

Ninaivu 0.1.0 is the general edition of a server that has run one household's library for a year. It has some 3,500 tests. The roadmap says what 1.0 still needs.

Install

Ninaivu runs on a computer that stays on: a desktop under the stairs, a mini PC, an old laptop, a Mac mini, a NAS that runs Docker. It needs Python 3.12 or newer when run from a checkout; the installers bring their own.

Windows

Download `Ninaivu-<version>-windows-x64.exe` from the latest release and run it. It installs for your account only (no administrator prompt), puts a private Python and everything Ninaivu needs under `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Programs\Ninaivu`, and adds **Ninaivu** to the Start menu. Leave *Start Ninaivu at sign-in* ticked and it is always there.

Or, once the manifest is merged: `winget install Ninaivu.Ninaivu`.

Opening **Ninaivu** puts an icon in the system tray. Its menu starts and stops the server and opens the family app and the console. More on the tray.

macOS

Download the `.dmg` for your Mac — `arm64` for Apple silicon, `x86_64` for Intel — from the latest release, open it and drag **Ninaivu** to Applications. Or `brew install --cask ninaivu`.

Ninaivu lives in the menu bar, not the Dock. Its menu starts and stops the server, opens the family app and the console, and can start at sign-in.

Docker

For a NAS or a Linux box:

```
git clone https://github.com/javajaga-usa/Ninaivu.git
cd Ninaivu
cp installers/docker/.env.example installers/docker/.env # set MEDIA_DIR to your
photo folder
docker compose -f installers/docker/docker-compose.yml up -d
```

The family app answers on port 5000 and the console on 3000. The operations guide covers systemd, reverse proxies, HTTPS and large libraries.

From a checkout

```
git clone https://github.com/javajaga-usa/Ninaivu.git
cd Ninaivu
start.cmd ~/Pictures           # Windows: or double-click start.cmd
sh launcher/start.sh ~/Pictures # macOS and Linux
```

The launcher makes a virtual environment, installs what is missing, finds free ports and opens your browser.

What you see first

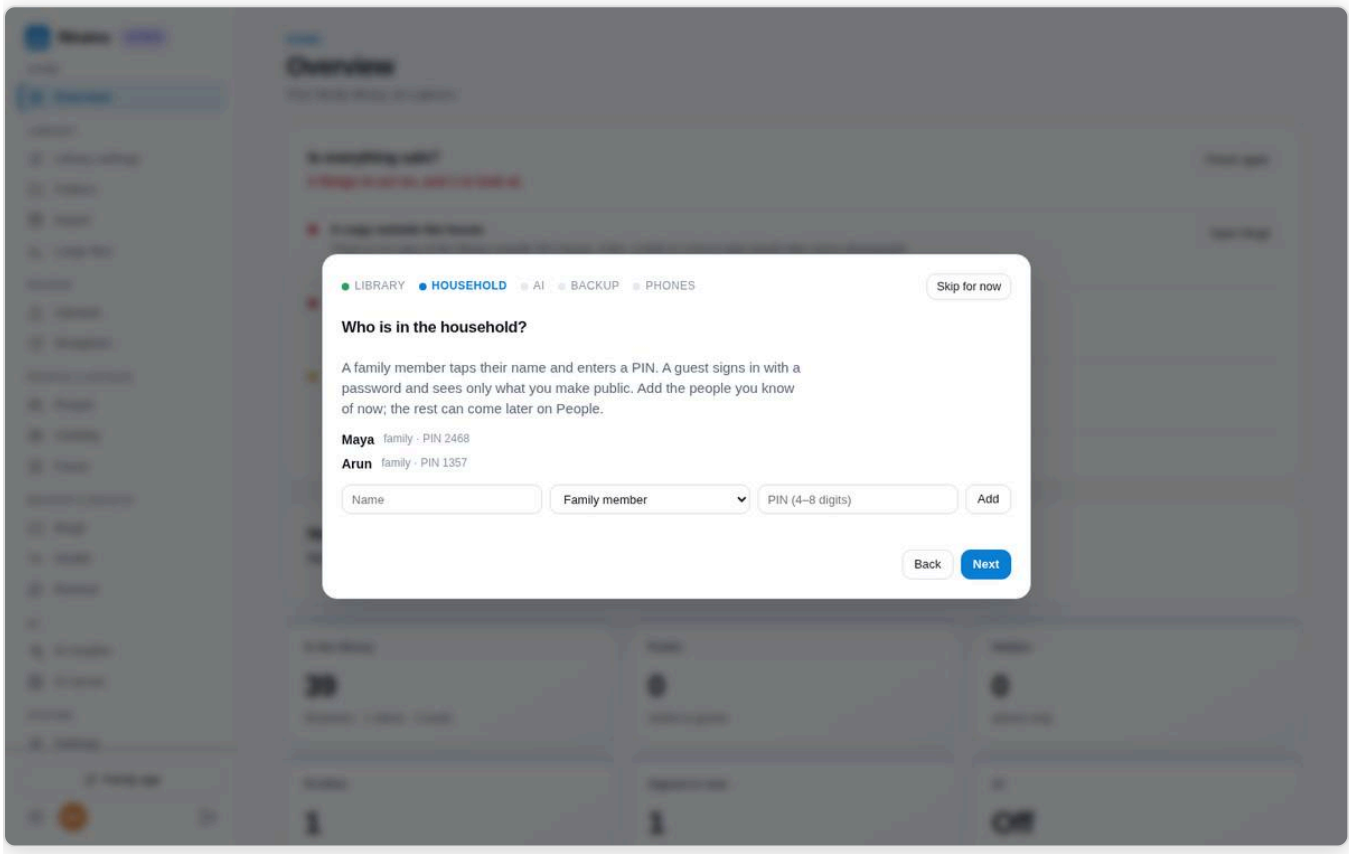
The first screen makes the administrator. After that the console walks you through the first day.

Two addresses

Ninaivu has two faces on two ports: the **family app**, where everyone looks at the library, and the **console**, where the administrator runs it. The console is bound to the computer itself by default; the family app is on the home network.

The first day

Right after the administrator is made, the console walks through the five things a new library needs. Each step can be skipped and each is just a page of the console, so nothing here is a second way of doing anything.



1. Where are the photographs?

Choose the folder that holds them. Ninaivu only ever reads it: nothing is moved, renamed or changed. You can add more folders later on **Library settings**, and sweep old drives and memory cards into one dated archive with **Import** — which also understands a Google Photos Takeout export, dates, places, descriptions and albums included.

2. Who is in the household?

A **family member** taps their name and enters a PIN. A **guest** signs in with a password and sees only what you make public. Add the people you know of now; the rest can come later on **People**. More on roles.

3. What should Ninaivu work out by itself?

Everything here runs on this computer. **Find the people in photographs** needs a 37 MB model, downloaded when you turn it on. **Name the places** is an 11 MB list of places. **Read the words in photographs** needs the text reader from Extras. Each pass takes time on a large library and can be turned off part-way. More on AI.

4. A copy outside the house

A fire, a theft or a failing disk would take every photograph. **Mugil** keeps an encrypted copy on Google Drive and checks once a week that it restores. It needs a Google account, which takes a few minutes on the Mugil page; the Overview reminds you until it is done. More on backup.

5. On the household's phones

Open the address shown on a phone on the home Wi-Fi and add it to the home screen: it opens like an app, and photographs the phone takes can back themselves up to the house.

After that

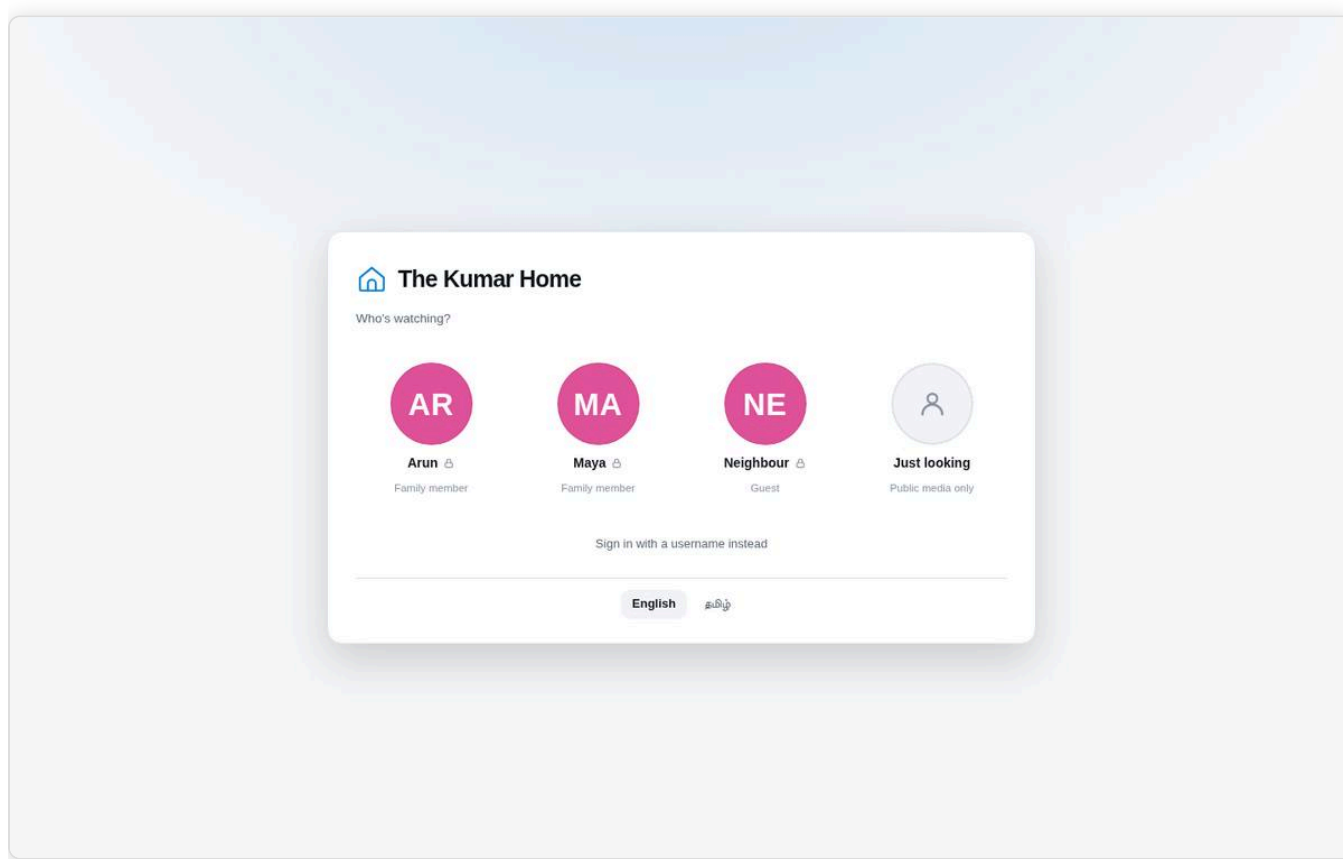
The console's **Overview** answers two questions before anything else: *is everything safe?* and *what needs you?* — uploads to approve, faces without a name, photographs that may be on their side. Come back to it now and then.

Family and roles

Three roles, and every photograph has a visibility. That model is the product; everything else is built on it.

Role	Signs in with	Sees
Administrator	a password, on the console	everything, and runs the server
Family member	a PIN, from the profile picker	everything marked for the family
Guest	a password	only what was chosen for them

With **open browsing** on, a visitor can look at what is public without signing in at all; off, the whole library is private.



Visibility

Every folder has a setting — everyone, family, or admins only — and every photograph can be set on its own. **People & access → Visibility** holds the rules for everyone first

(whether visitors may browse, whether explicit content is screened, how far back in time each role may look) and then each folder's own setting. Every change can be undone in one step.

A family member can also be given a folder of their own: a private corner of the library that only they and the administrator see.

Sharing

A link for one photograph or an album, with an optional password, scoped to what its maker could already see. A guest can never share more than they can look at.

Faces and names

People & access → **Faces** shows the people the face matcher found, grouped. Name one face and the rest of its group follow. Names never leave the machine; nothing about faces is sent anywhere.

Uploads

Photographs the family send from their phones wait under **Review** → **Uploads** for the administrator to file or refuse. A family member's edit in Sudar waits the same way. Nothing a family member does changes the library without the administrator seeing it.

Dates

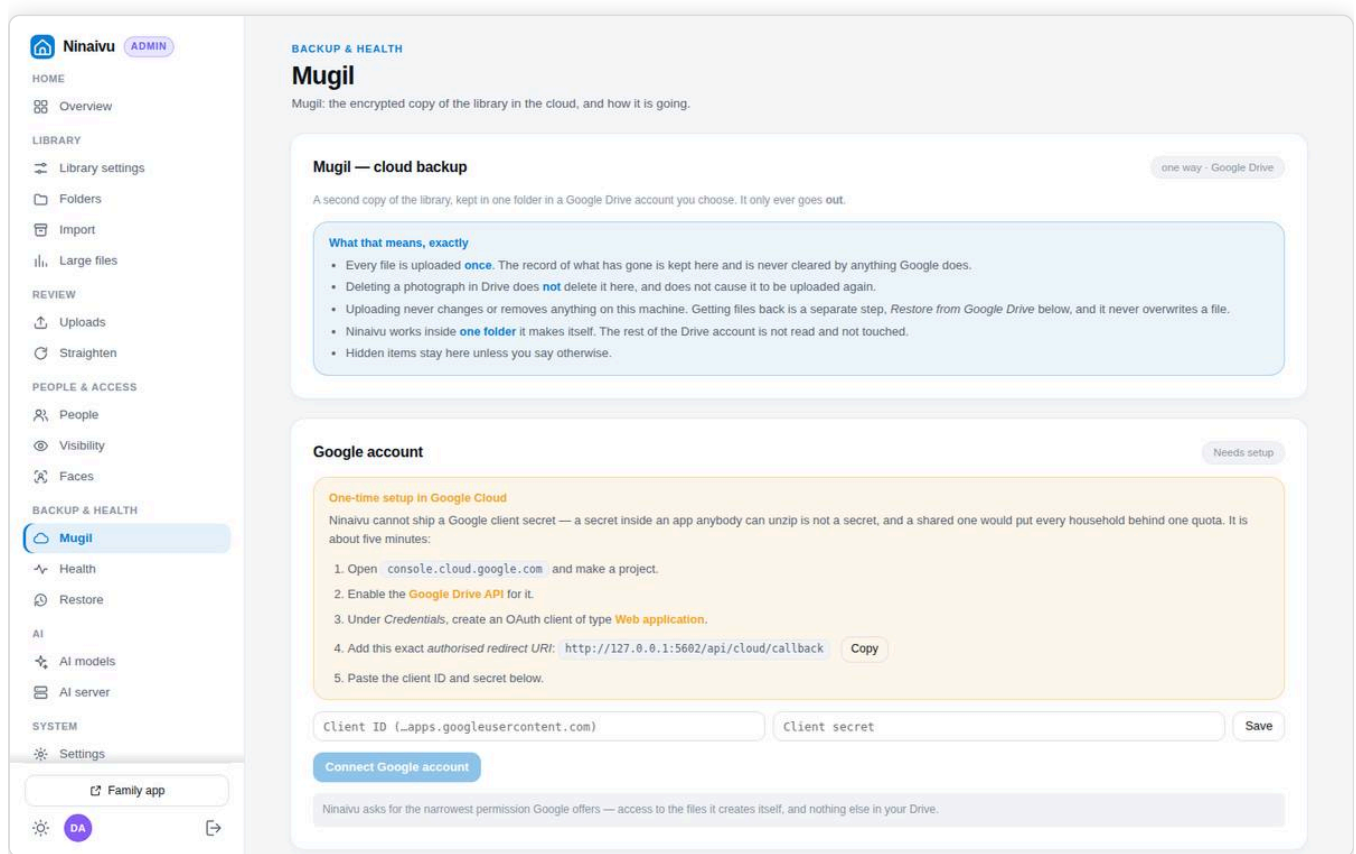
A role can be limited to a window of time — guests see this year's photographs, say, and nothing older. Date access.

Backup

Three things can lose a library: the disk, the house, and a mistake. Ninaivu keeps a copy against each.

Mugil — a copy outside the house

Mugil (முகில், *cloud*) keeps an encrypted copy of the library on Google Drive. It is one way: nothing in Drive can change, move or remove anything at home, and deleting a photograph from Drive does not delete it here.



On the **Mugil** page: the Google account (a few minutes, once), what is sent and what is kept back, the speed and the hours it may use, the encryption key and its **recovery file**, and the weekly test that brings a few files back and checks they match.

The recovery file

The copy in Drive is useless without the key. Ninaivu writes a recovery file and asks you to keep it somewhere that is not this computer — a USB stick in a drawer, a password manager. Without it, a lost computer means a lost library, however good the copy in Drive is. What is in it.

Other destinations — a second disk, a NAS path, S3, WebDAV — are on the roadmap.

Restore

Backup & health → Restore brings photographs back from the cloud copy in three steps: what to bring back, where to put it, and the key. Nothing here ever overwrites a file that is already there.

The index

The index — faces, names, albums, who may see what — is copied on this computer every few hours (**Health** shows the copies) and into Drive with the library, so a lost computer loses nothing but time. Moving to another machine.

Phones

Photographs a phone takes back themselves up to the house over the home Wi-Fi, into **Review → Uploads**, where the administrator files them.

Is everything safe?

The console's Overview runs the household's safety checks every time it opens — a copy outside the house, a backup that restores, copies of the index, healthy drives — and says what to do about each.

Remote access

At home, Ninaivu answers to a name on the home network (`ninaivu.local`). Away from home, it is reached through something the household set up — and Ninaivu treats *how* as a choice, made once on **System** → **Server** → **Away from home**.

Choice	What it is	What it needs
Tailscale	A private network between your own devices; the easiest	Tailscale installed on the server and on each phone
WireGuard	The same idea, set up by hand	the tunnel, and its subnets typed here
A tunnel	Cloudflare Tunnel or the like: a public name that reaches the house	the tunnel, and the name typed here
Your own reverse proxy	Caddy or nginx in front, with a certificate	the proxy (examples)
Nothing	Home network only	—

The default works out Tailscale by itself when it is on the machine.

Each choice says what it still needs, decides which addresses count as *away from home*, which addresses are listed for the household, and whose certificate is served.

HTTPS

Ninaivu makes its own certificate authority and serves HTTPS with it. Each device that should not see a warning trusts that certificate once; the tray and the console's Server page have the button, and the tray page has the details for Windows and macOS. Tailscale and a reverse proxy bring their own certificates.

What never goes out

Faces, names, the index, the photographs: none of it is sent anywhere by any of these. Remote access is a way *in* to the house. The only thing Ninaivu sends out on its own is the encrypted backup, to the account you chose, and a once-a-day request to GitHub's releases page to see whether a newer version is out (**Server** has the switch).

AI

Everything runs on your own computer. No photograph, face or name is sent to anyone by any of this.

Two kinds of computer

Ninaivu is tested on two kinds of machine, and works out which yours is when it starts (**System** → **Performance** says which, and why):

	Basic	Full
The machine	2 GB of memory, no graphics processor: a mini PC, an old laptop, a single-board computer	a graphics processor, or Apple silicon
The gallery, albums, sharing, roles	yes	yes
Faces, grouped and named	yes	yes
Sideways photographs put right	yes	yes
Places named from the location	yes	yes
Search by words in names, dates, places and people	yes	yes
Mugil, the encrypted copy	yes	yes
Tags, natural-language search and descriptions from the image model	—	yes
Videos described from several moments	—	yes
Text read from photographs	—	yes
Creative Studio: generative edits, object removal, upscaling	—	yes

A Basic machine never tries to load the large models, so it starts quickly and stays quick. Setting `hardware_tier` on **All settings** overrides the measurement.

What each pass does

AI → AI models has a switch for each, saying which model it needs and whether that model is here.

- **Faces** — a 37 MB detector and matcher. Groups are named on **Faces**; name one and the rest follow.
- **Places** — an 11 MB list of places; the photograph's own location becomes "Paris" or "the beach".
- **Sideways photographs** — a 77 MB model that says which way up a photograph goes; what it finds waits on **Review → Straighten** for approval, and by default it looks by itself after every scan.
- **Text in photographs** — the text reader from **Extras**; slow on a processor.
- **The image model (Full)** — CLIP or SigLIP: tags, "the beach at sunset" search, descriptions. Downloaded once; after that Ninaivu tells the model libraries to make no request at all (`HF_HUB_OFFLINE`).
- **Videos (Full)** — described from several moments rather than the poster frame.

Sudar

Sudar (சுடர், *glow*) edits in the browser: light, colour, straightening, crops, looks, and suggestions measured from the picture. "Make it warmer" in plain words. The original is never changed; a copy is saved beside it.

Extensions

Anything that cannot keep the core's two promises — nothing leaves the house unless you chose where, and it runs on a small machine — is an extension, off until switched on under **AI models → Extensions**, and its switch says what it does:

- **Creative Studio** — generative edits and the heavy tools with large models, on this computer with a GPU or on a ComfyUI server in the house. Nothing leaves the house.
- **Gemini** — edits and descriptions from Google's models. A copy of the photograph goes to Google when, and only when, a request names it.

More on extensions.

Troubleshooting

The phone cannot open Ninaivu

- The phone must be on the home Wi-Fi, not mobile data.
- Use the address the console's **Server** page lists under *for the household*. `localhost` only works on the server itself.
- **Network access** on the Server page must be on; off, Ninaivu answers on the server only. Turning it on needs a restart.
- Windows: the first start asks to allow Ninaivu through the firewall; if that was refused, allow it in Windows Security → Firewall → Allow an app.

The browser warns about the certificate

Ninaivu serves HTTPS with its own certificate authority. Trust it once per device: the tray's **Trust the HTTPS certificate**, or the Server page's button, and the tray page for doing it by hand on Windows and macOS. Or put Tailscale or a reverse proxy in front, which bring their own.

Nothing appears after choosing the folder

The library is indexed in the background; a large one takes a while. The Overview's **Library** numbers and the Server page's log show it going. If the folder is on a drive that is not plugged in, the gallery says so rather than showing nothing.

The scan is slow

System → Performance says what this computer can do and what would help. On a small machine, turn off the passes you do not need on **AI models** (text in photographs and video moments are the expensive ones), or choose *power-saving* on the Server page while the household is using the computer. A scan can be stopped and picks up where it left off.

A model would not download

The models come from GitHub and Hugging Face. Check the machine has internet at the moment of the download; the AI models page says which file failed. Once a model is here nothing is asked of the internet again.

Mugil says the copy did not restore

The weekly test brings a few files back and compares them. If it fails, **Health** says which file and why; the usual causes are a changed Google password (sign in again on Mugil) and a full Drive.

Ninaivu will not start

The tray's **View the log** (or `.ninaivu-control/server.log` beside a checkout) has the reason. The common ones: the port is taken by another program (`--port` or the Server page changes it), the state folder is on a drive that is not mounted, or another Ninaivu is already running from the same state folder.

Moving to another computer

System → **Move to another computer** lists the three things that make an installation and, on the new machine, points the index at wherever the library landed without re-indexing. The details.

Getting help

Issues on GitHub. Say which version (**Settings** shows it), what you did, and what the log said.

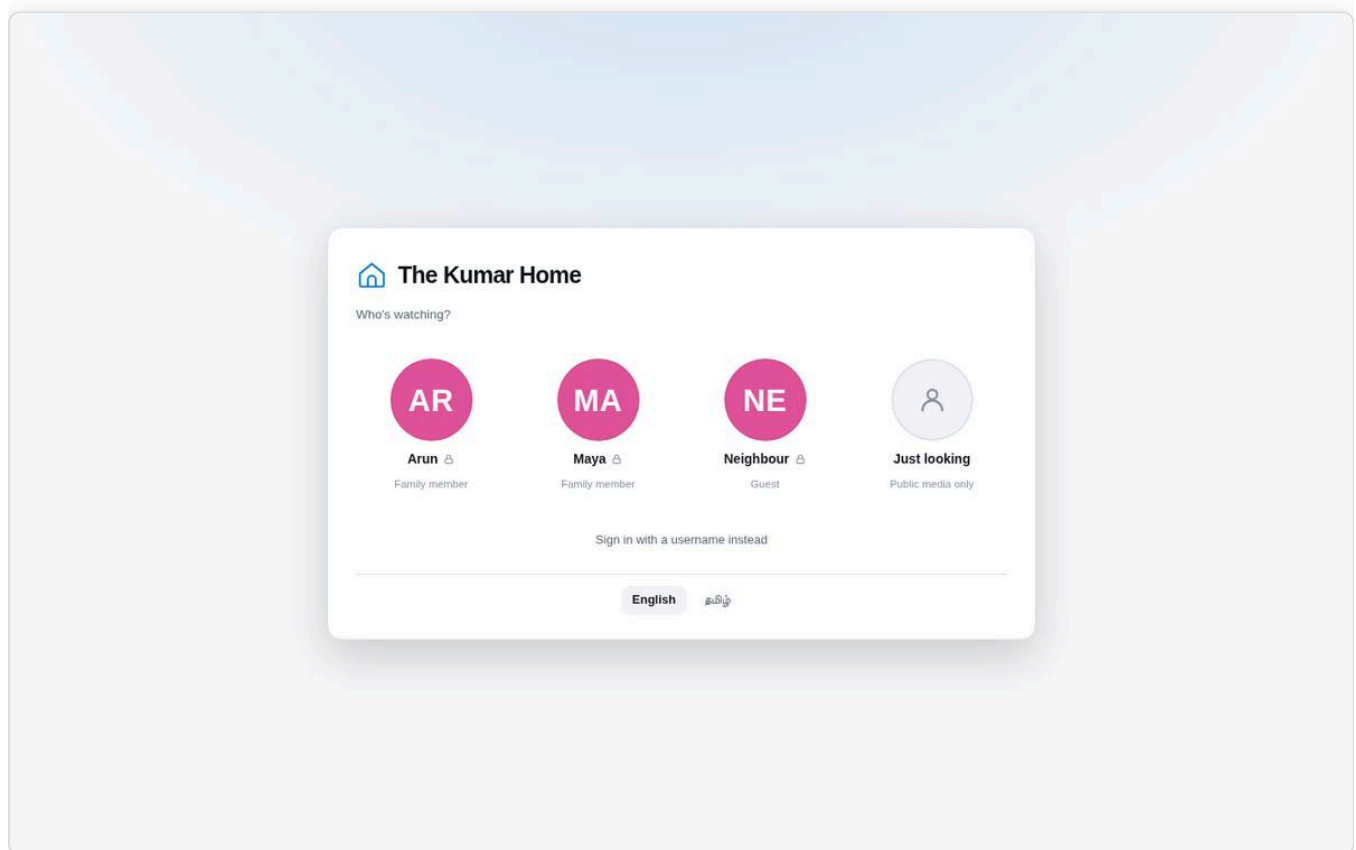
The family app

Everything a family member or guest needs, and nothing else. You do not need to know anything about servers to use Ninaivu: it opens like a website, and on a phone or tablet you add it to the home screen once and it behaves like an app.

Two things explain most of how it behaves:

- **Everything has a visibility.** Every photograph is *public*, *family* or *admins only*. What you see depends on which profile you came in as.
- **The management screens are somewhere else.** The administrator runs Ninaivu from a separate console on its own address. Nothing you can reach in the family app can change the library.

Coming in



The family app opens on the household's profiles. Tap yours. What that costs depends on how the administrator set it up:

Tap to enter nothing at all — right for the family tablet or a shared television

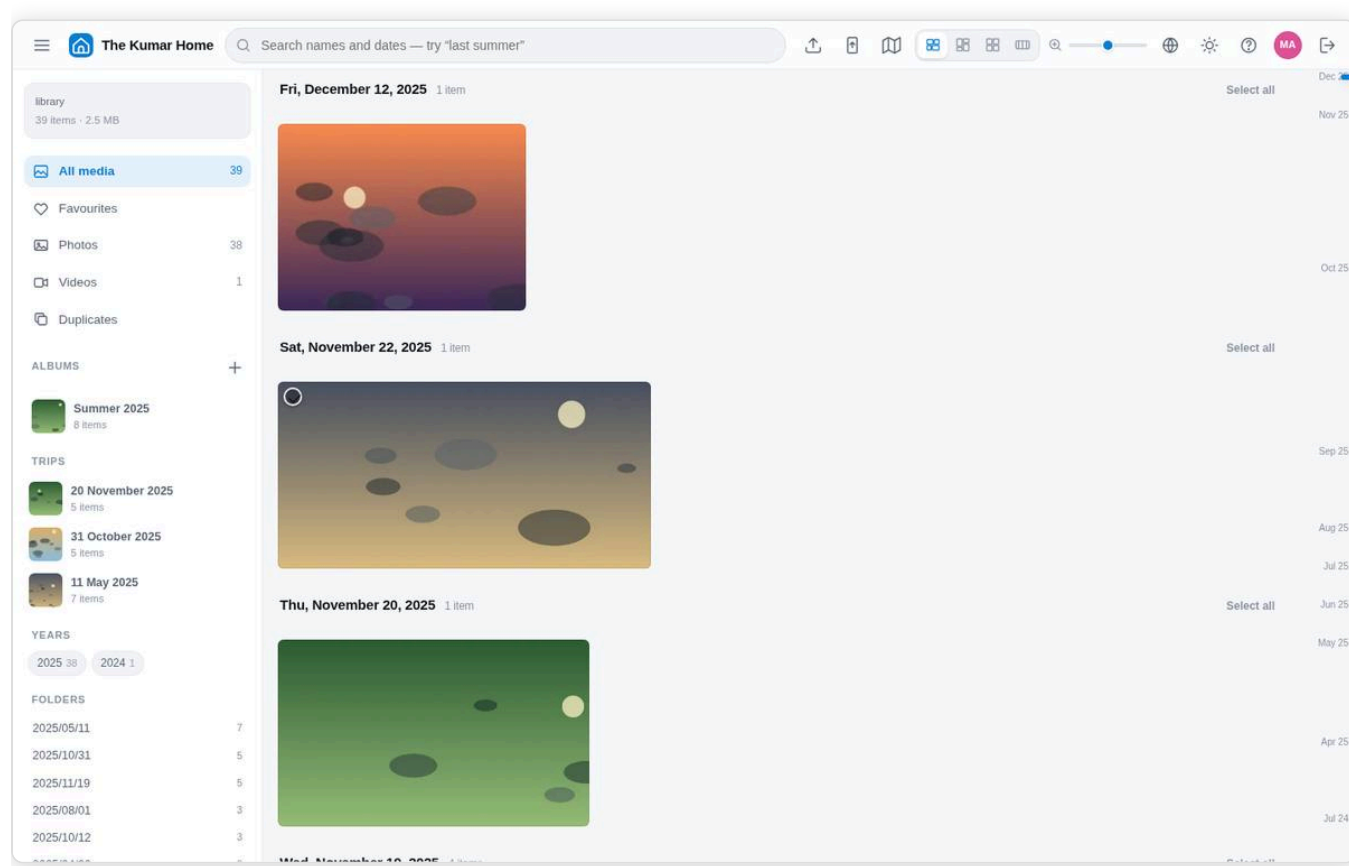
PIN four to eight digits, shown as a small lock on your tile

Password the full form, for guests and anyone who wants it

Just looking with open browsing on, a tile that needs no profile and shows only what is public

Administrators never appear on this picker; they sign in on the console. You can change your own name, colour and picture whatever your role.

The gallery



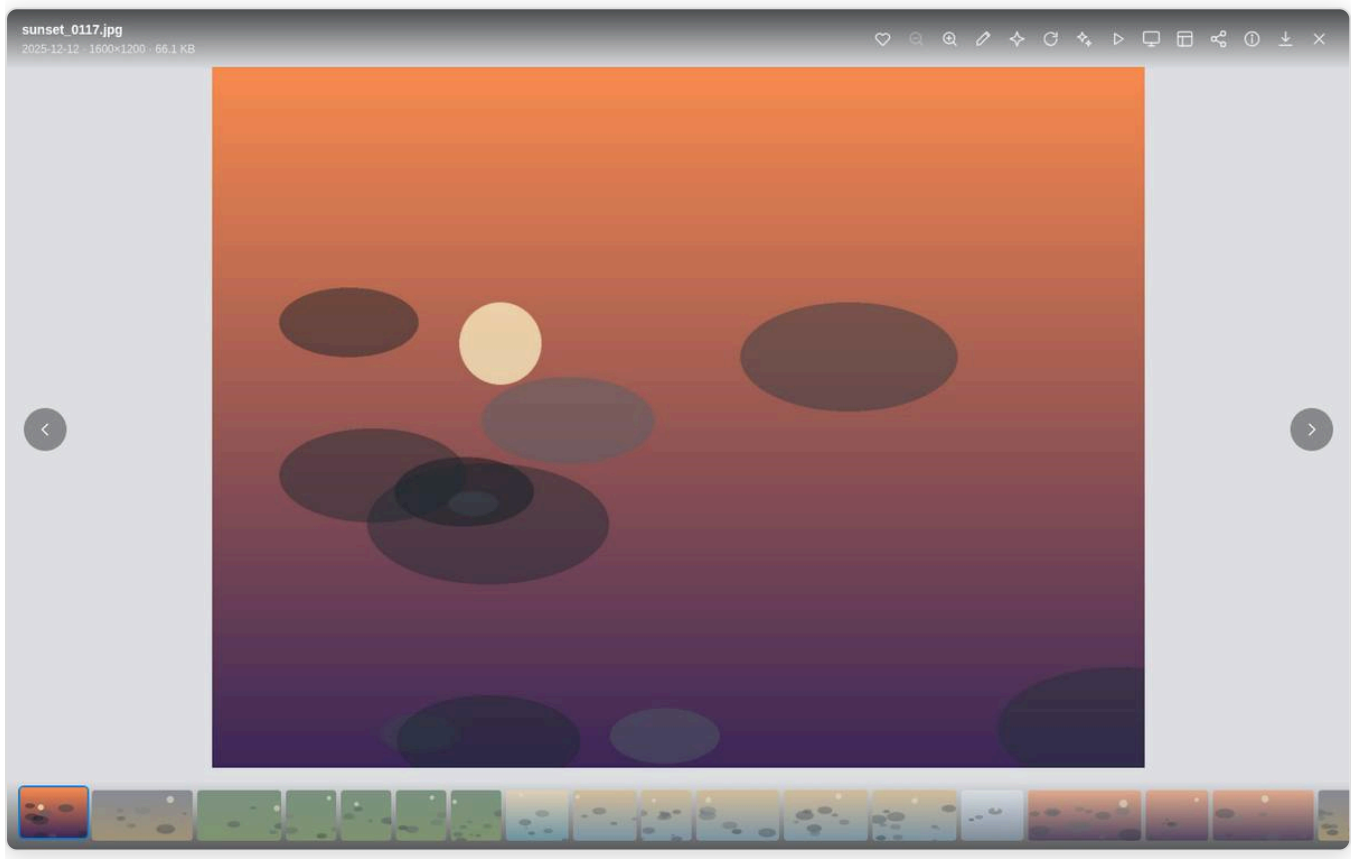
Everything you may see, newest first, grouped by day. Four layouts, and they are a real preference: **justified** suits mixed shapes, **masonry** tall photographs, **grid** scanning, **filmstrip** one long roll. **+** and **-** change the thumbnail size; **T** switches the theme.

The left column is the library's shape: photos, videos, favourites, duplicates the index found, albums, trips the dates suggest, then years and folders. Click any of them and it becomes a removable filter chip; chips stack, so *beach* + *2019* + a person is one click each. The strip down the right edge jumps anywhere in the library by month, as smoothly on a hundred thousand photographs as on a hundred.

Search takes plain words. On a Full machine (AI) the image model ranks results by how well the picture matches — "the beach at sunset" works as written, nobody tagged anything. On a Basic machine search covers names, dates, places, people and the words in file and folder names. The map button shows every located photograph grouped by place.

Selecting. Click the circle on a tile, Shift-click for a range, **X** on the focused tile, or **⌘/Ctrl+A** for everything shown. With a selection you can favourite, download or add to an album at once; an administrator also changes visibility in bulk.

A photograph



The whole photograph fitted to your screen, with its date, place and people, and the actions your role may take.

- **Zoom** with the wheel or a pinch, drag to pan, double-click to zoom to a point; **0** puts it back. Arrow keys or a swipe move on.
- **I** — **details**: camera, lens, ISO, aperture, where the date came from, the location if the file carried one.
- **S** — **find similar**: the other eleven attempts at the same photograph.
- **F** — **favourite**. Favourites are private to you, even when several people share the same folder. Guests cannot favourite.
- **R** — **rotate** (Shift for the other way). A turn saved by a family member is saved for the whole household; the file itself is not touched unless an administrator writes the turn

into it.

- **D** — download the original (family members and administrators).
- **Share** — a link for this photograph, with an optional password, that shows exactly what you could already see.
- **Open in Sudar** — the photo studio, below.
- **Space** — a slideshow. **K** — the **Ambient Frame**: full screen, a slow drift across each picture, a clock in the corner, a new photograph every few seconds. It is the reason to keep an old tablet on the kitchen wall. **Esc** comes back.

Live Photos and motion photos play their short clip; Ninaivu pairs the still and the video during indexing.

Press **?** anywhere for the full list of keys.

People

If faces are on, a row of people appears in the sidebar. Click one to see that person's photographs. The count is *yours* — how many you are allowed to open — so two people in the house may see different numbers for the same person. Naming people and confirming matches are the administrator's job on the console; in the family app, People is read-only.

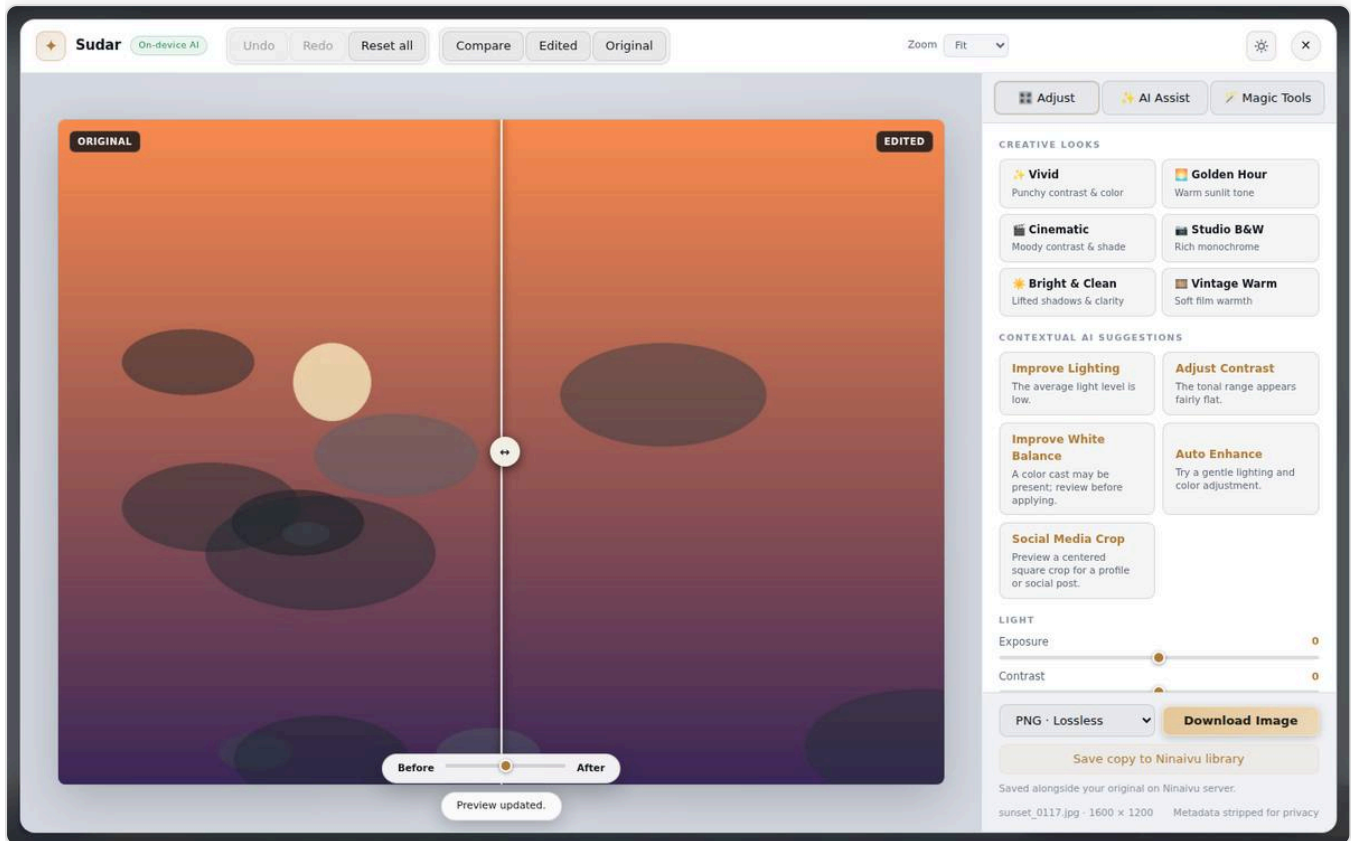
Albums

Any family member can make an album and add to it. Albums hold references, not copies: deleting an album never touches a photograph. An album can be shared as a link, with an optional password.

Sending photographs

Family members can upload from the gallery; the files wait for the administrator under **Review → Uploads** before they join the library, and a name that already exists gets a timestamp rather than overwriting anything. A phone added to the home screen can back up the photographs it takes the same way. The limit is 512 MB per upload. Guests cannot upload.

Sudar, the photo studio



Sudar (சூடர், *glow*) edits a photograph in the browser: looks, suggestions measured from the picture, light and colour sliders, straightening and crops, with the original on the left and the edit on the right. "Make it warmer" in plain words works too. The original file is never changed; a copy can be saved beside it, and a family member's copy waits for the administrator's approval like an upload.

With the Creative Studio extension on (AI), Sudar also does generative edits, object removal and upscaling — on this computer or on an AI server in the house. Nothing leaves the house.

Sound recordings

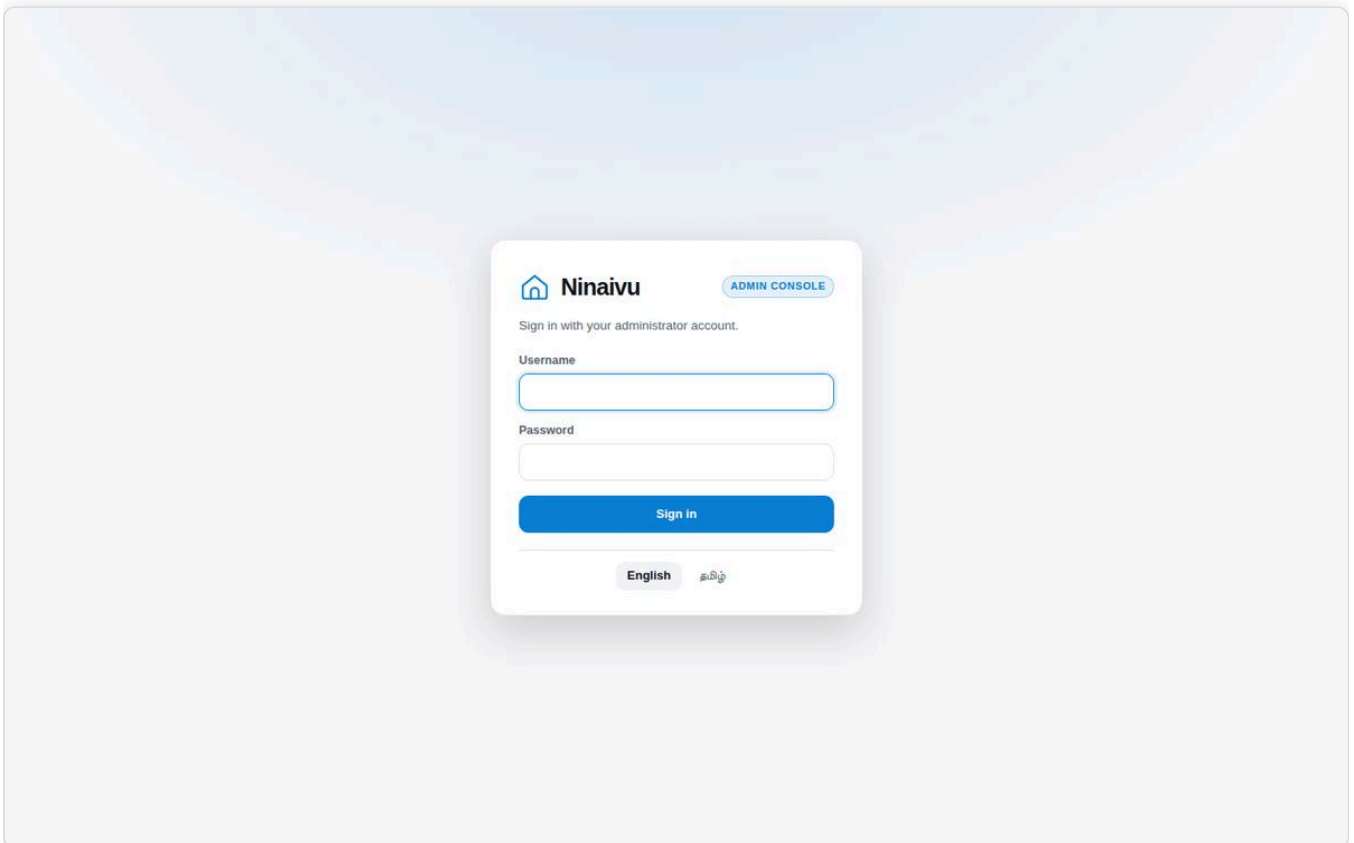
Sound files in the library — voice notes, voicemail, dictation swept up from old drives — are administrator-only, always. A photograph is looked at on purpose; a recording plays out loud the moment somebody taps it, in a room with other people in it.

On a phone

Open the address the administrator gives you while on the home Wi-Fi, then **Add to Home Screen**. It opens like an app and works offline for what it has already shown. Away from home, it works only if the household set up remote access.

The console

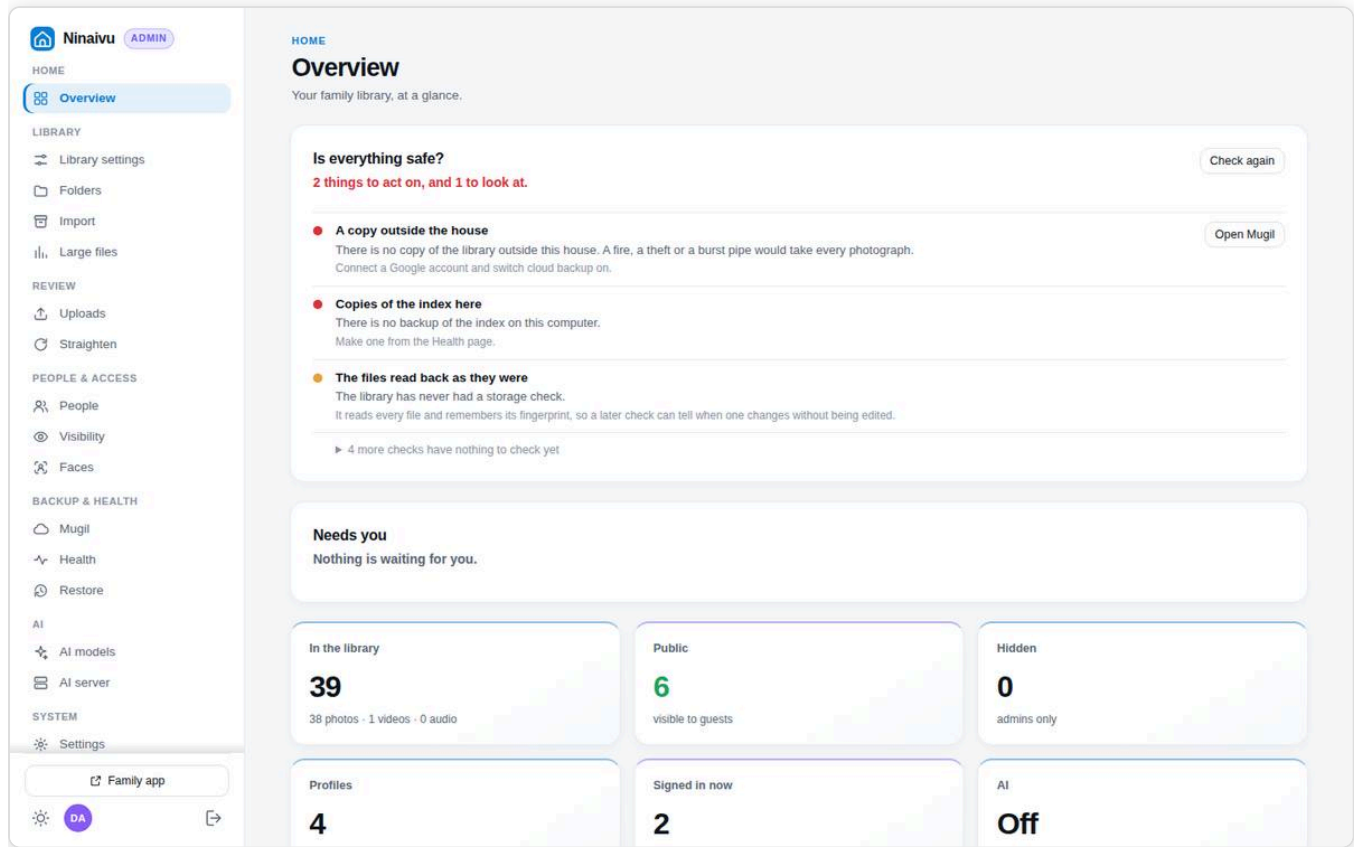
Everything the administrator does: getting a library indexed, deciding who sees what, and the tools — Import, Faces, Mugil, Health. The console answers on its own port, bound to the computer itself by default, and always takes a password, never a PIN.



Two apps, two ports

The family app and the console are two applications in one process. The console's routes are *absent* from the family app, not merely forbidden — nothing you can reach from the family port changes the library. A session made on the family app cannot open the console, even an administrator's.

Home — Overview



The first screen answers two questions before anything else. **Is everything safe?** runs the household's safety checks — a copy outside the house, a backup that restores, copies of the index, healthy drives — and says what to do about each. **Needs you** counts what is waiting for a person: uploads to approve, faces without a name, photographs that may be on their side, things that went wrong. Then the numbers, and what each role would actually see. The Overview is also where the first day opens, once.

Library

Import

LIBRARY

Import

Bring your memories together in one organized archive.

Consolidate drives into one archive

Sweeps photos, video and audio off however many old drives, cards and backup folders you have into one archive filed as YYYY/MM/DD. Sources are opened read-only and **nothing is ever deleted** — every copy is re-read from disk and SHA-256 matched before it counts.

engine v2.9 · archive-as-source

1 Source drives and folders

Every subfolder is scanned, however deep. Each folder gets its own Photos / Video / Audio switches.

No sources yet. Add a folder below — a drive letter is fine, and every folder beneath it is included.

e.g. D:\OldPhotos or /Volumes/Backup Browse... Add source

SCAN EVERY FOLDER FOR ☒ Photos ☒ Video ☒ Audio Apply to all

2 Archive destination

Where the consolidated archive is built. Pick the archive's own root — choose a folder inside one and Ninaivu uses the root instead, and says so.

e.g. C:\MasterArchive Browse...

☒ Deep scan — identify files by content, not just by extension

3 Run

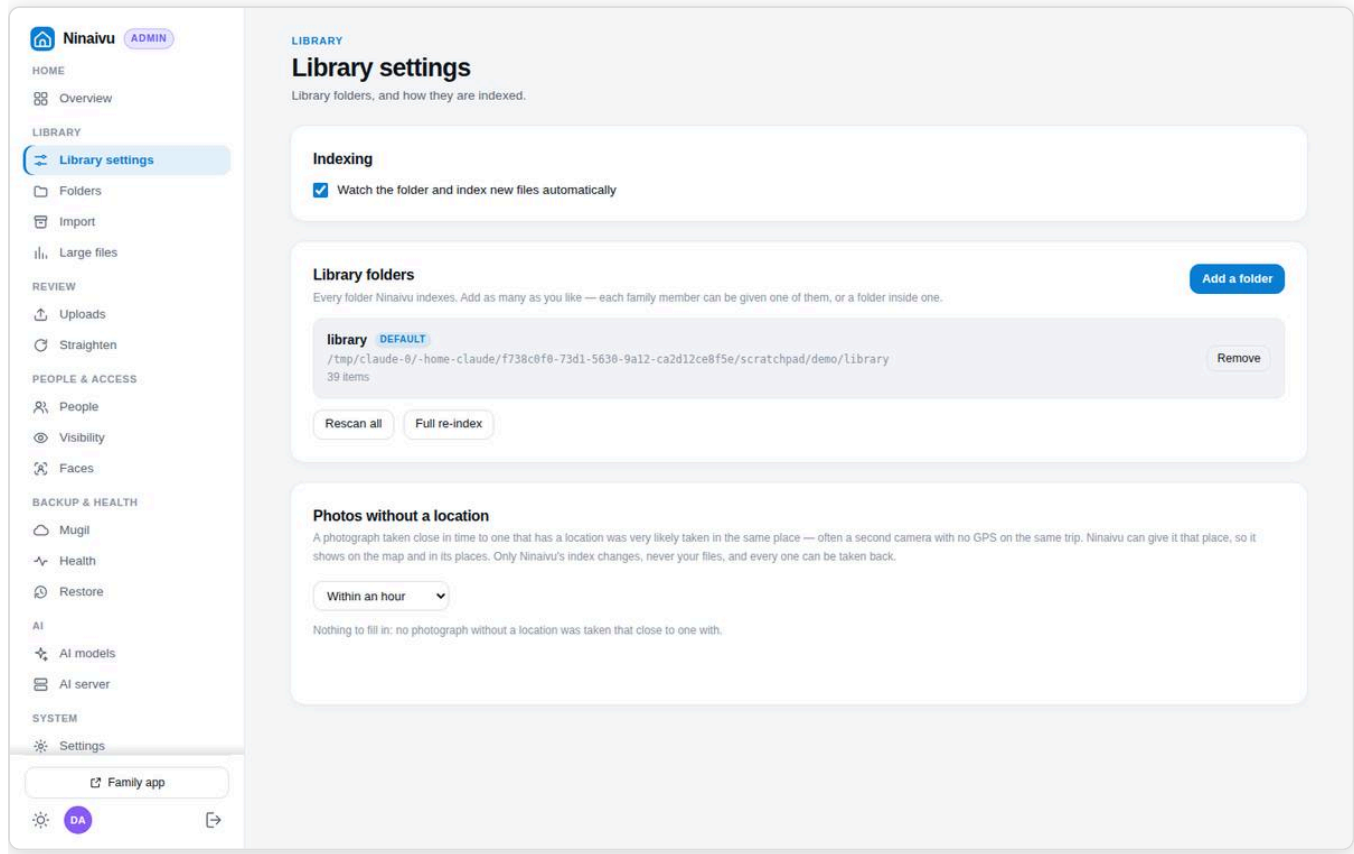
Start consolidation Dry run

Audit archive Retry failed Export manifest Recovery report Reset report

The first Library page on purpose: a library usually begins with old drives, memory cards and backup folders, swept into one archive laid out as YYYY/MM/DD . Every file is hashed on the way in and read back to verify the copy; duplicates are recognised by content and left in place, logged; sources are only ever read. **Dry run** decides everything and writes nothing. **Start** also resumes: an interrupted run picks up where it stopped. Files under 60 KB — icons, thumbnails — are left alone.

When the run has finished the page offers to **add the archive to the library**. A Google Photos Takeout export comes across whole: its sidecars give the dates, places and descriptions, and once the archive is indexed the page offers to **make its albums** from the copies it kept. The **Archive Guardian** re-reads a rotating sample of archived files every day and says when one has changed.

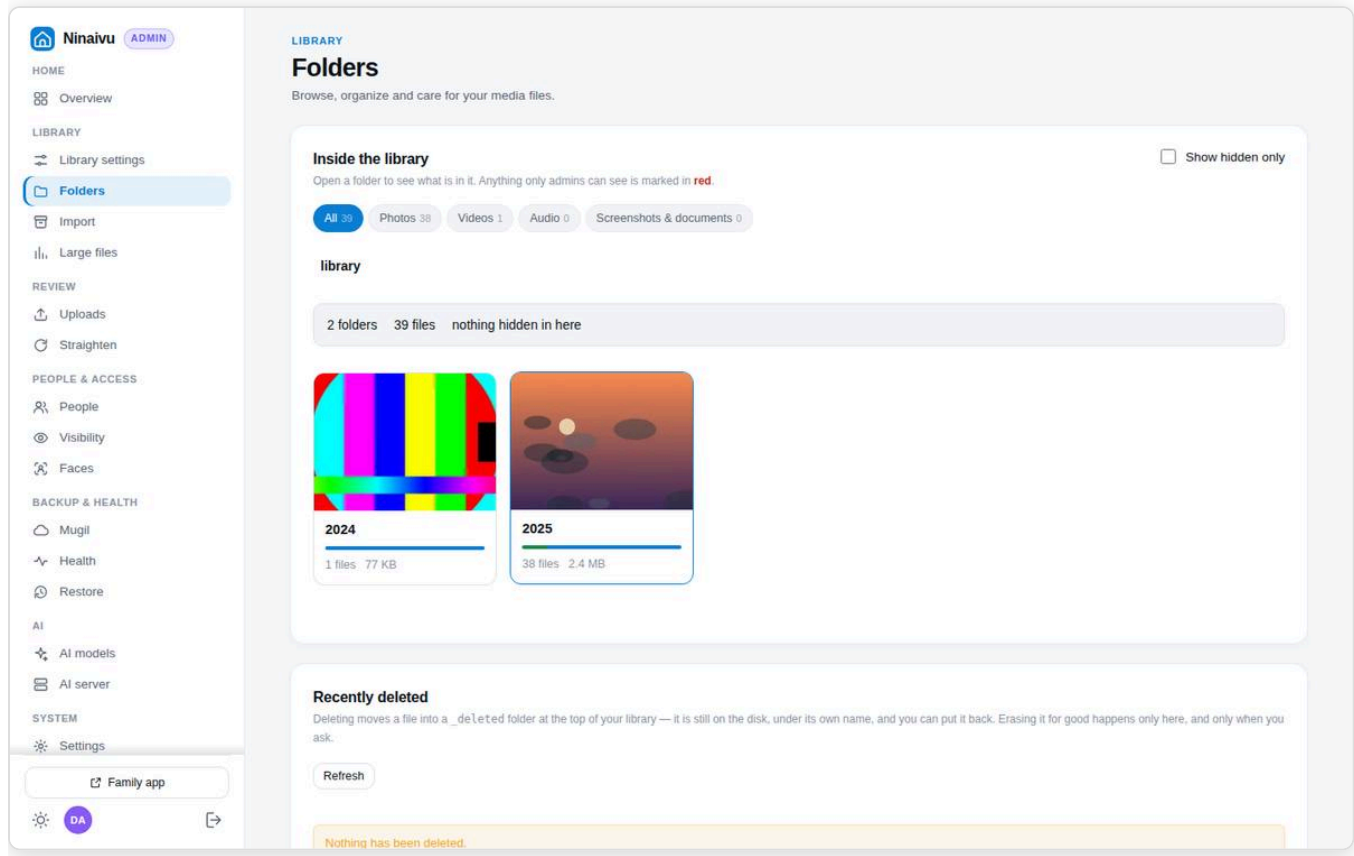
Library settings



Which folders make up the library, and how they are indexed: whether Ninaivu watches them for changes, whether hidden files are indexed, what the scan works out by itself. Add as many folders as you like; a folder on a drive that is unplugged stays a library folder and the gallery says so rather than showing nothing.

Where the dates come from: the camera's own date first, then the container's metadata, then a Takeout sidecar, then a YYYY/MM/DD folder path, then a date in the file name, and only then the file's modification time. The viewer's details panel says which one was used.

Folders



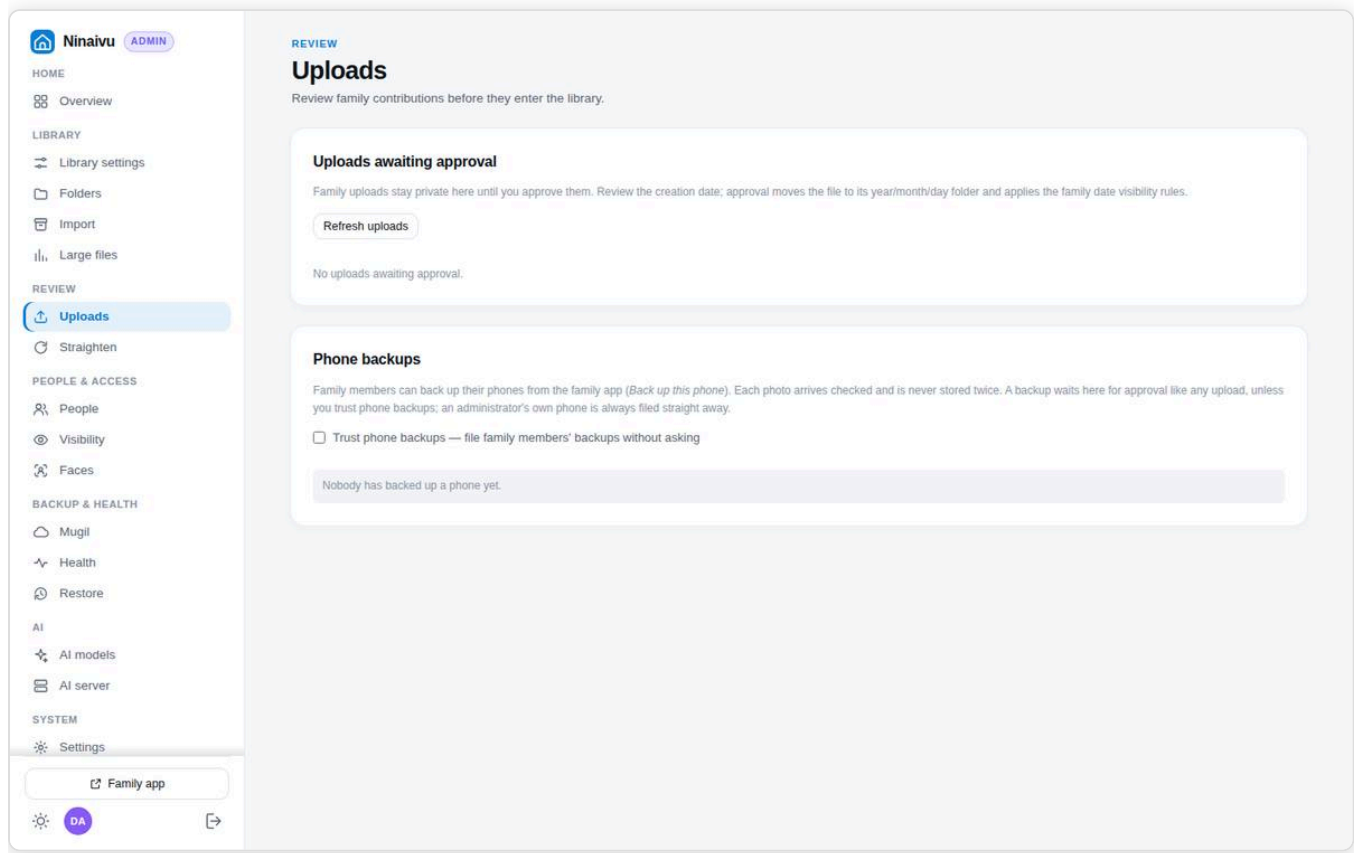
The library as folders, with what is in each and each folder's visibility, and the **recycle bin**. Deleting in Ninaivu moves a file into a `_deleted` folder beside the library, where it can be put back with its faces and albums intact; nothing is erased for good unless you set a number of days on All settings.

Large files

The files taking the most space, to look over once and mark as reviewed.

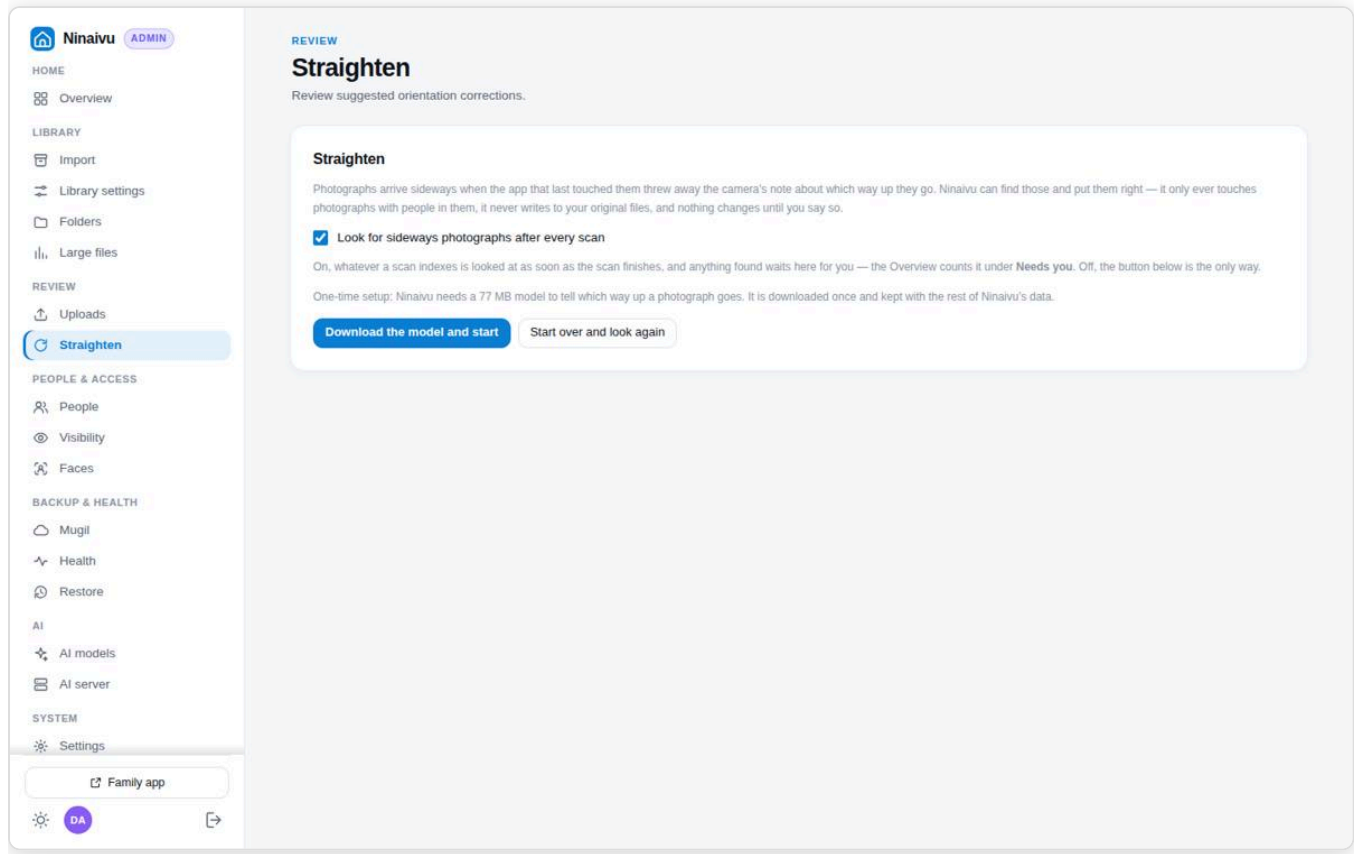
Review

Uploads



Photographs the family sent from their phones, and edits saved in Sudar, waiting to be filed or refused; and the phones backing themselves up to the house. Nothing a family member sends joins the library without passing here.

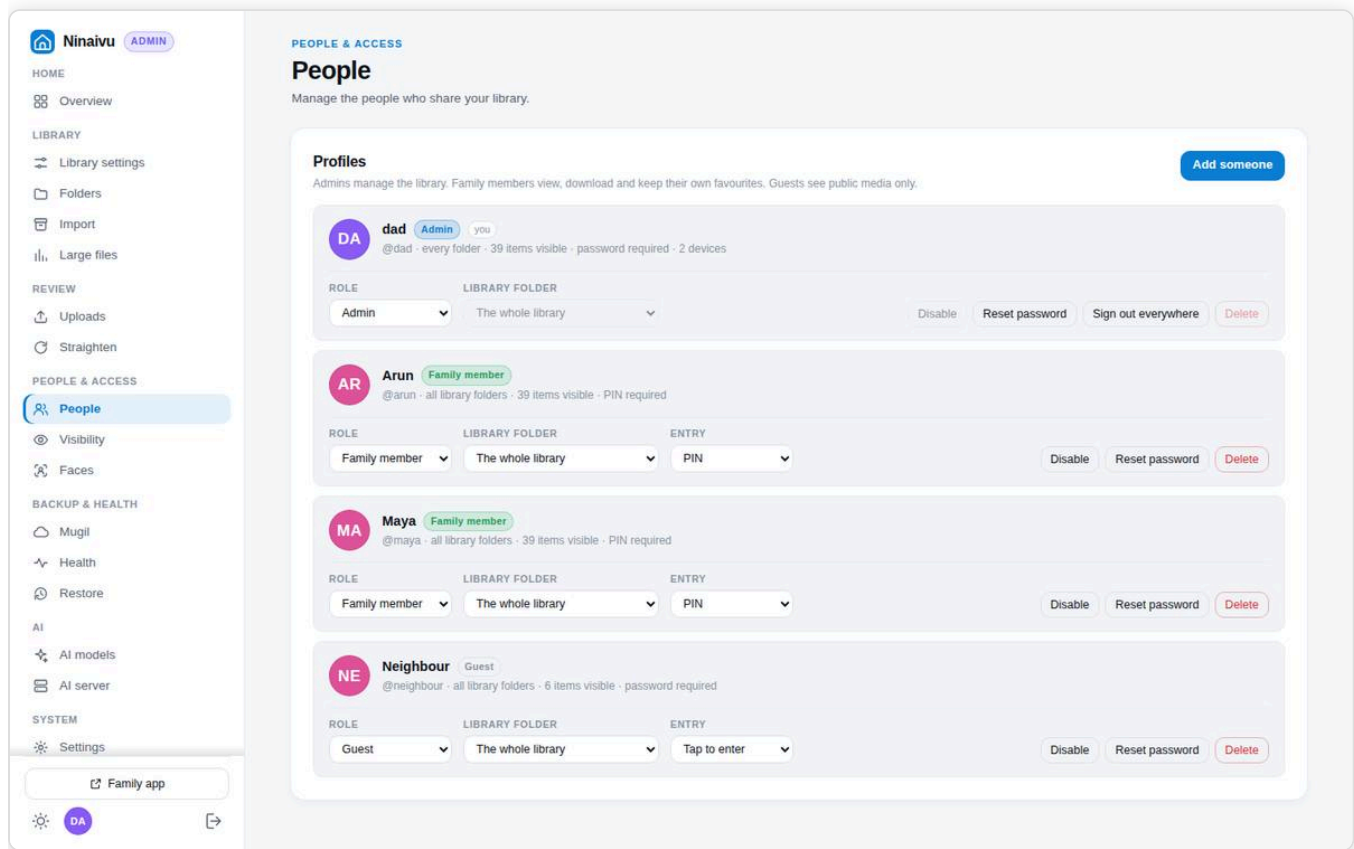
Straighten



Photographs the model thinks are on their side, strongest guess first, to approve or dismiss one at a time. It only ever suggests a quarter turn, and by default only for photographs with a person in them — a found face is a second witness that this way up is the way a person stands. By default the looking happens by itself after every scan, over what the scan indexed; the switch at the top turns that off, leaving the button. **Undo** puts back the last batch exactly, thumbnails included.

People & access

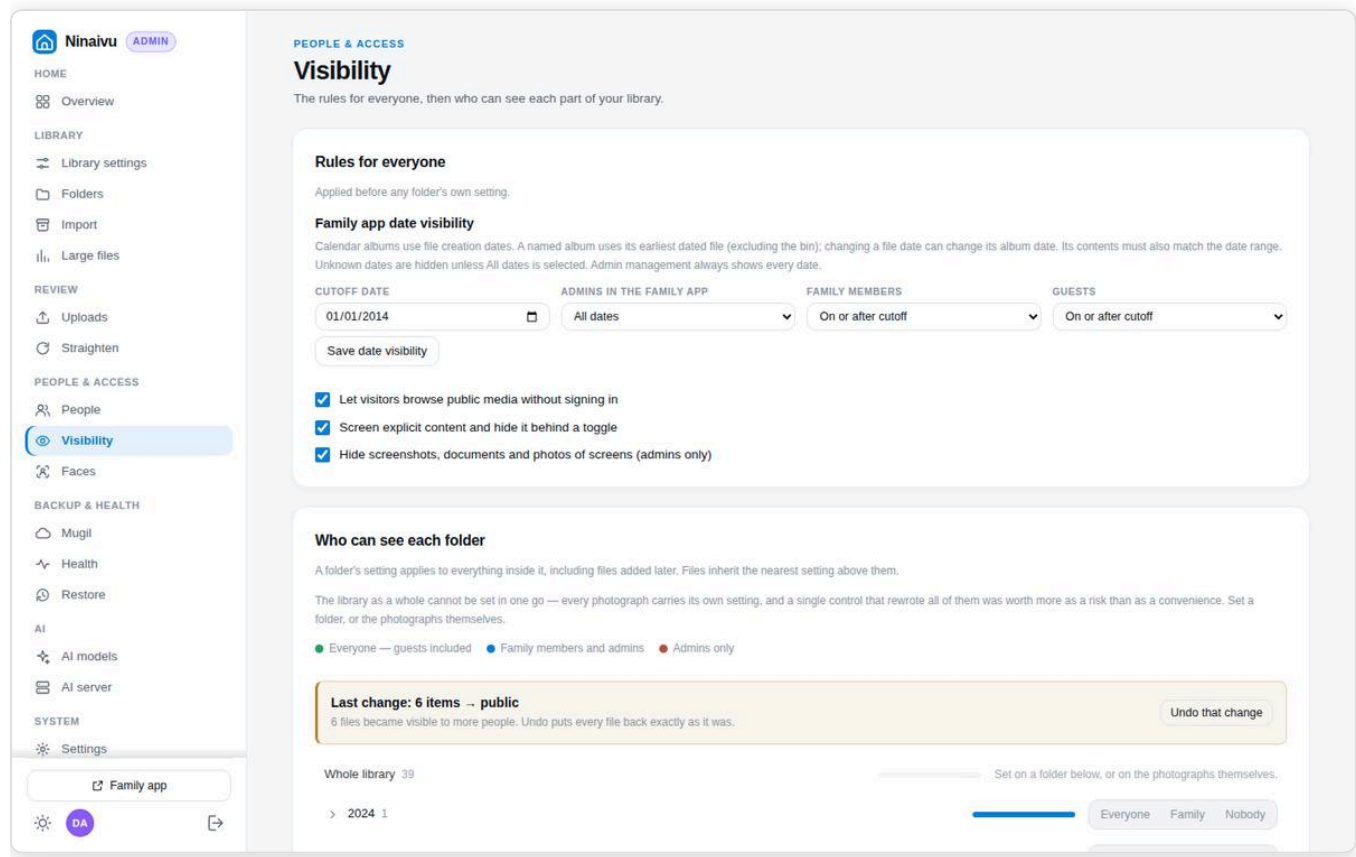
People



The household's profiles: one administrator, family members, guests. Each has a role, a way in (a PIN, a password, or a tap), and optionally a folder of their own — any library folder, or any folder inside one. Assignment and visibility stack, and the narrower always wins: a guest given a folder still sees only what is public in it.

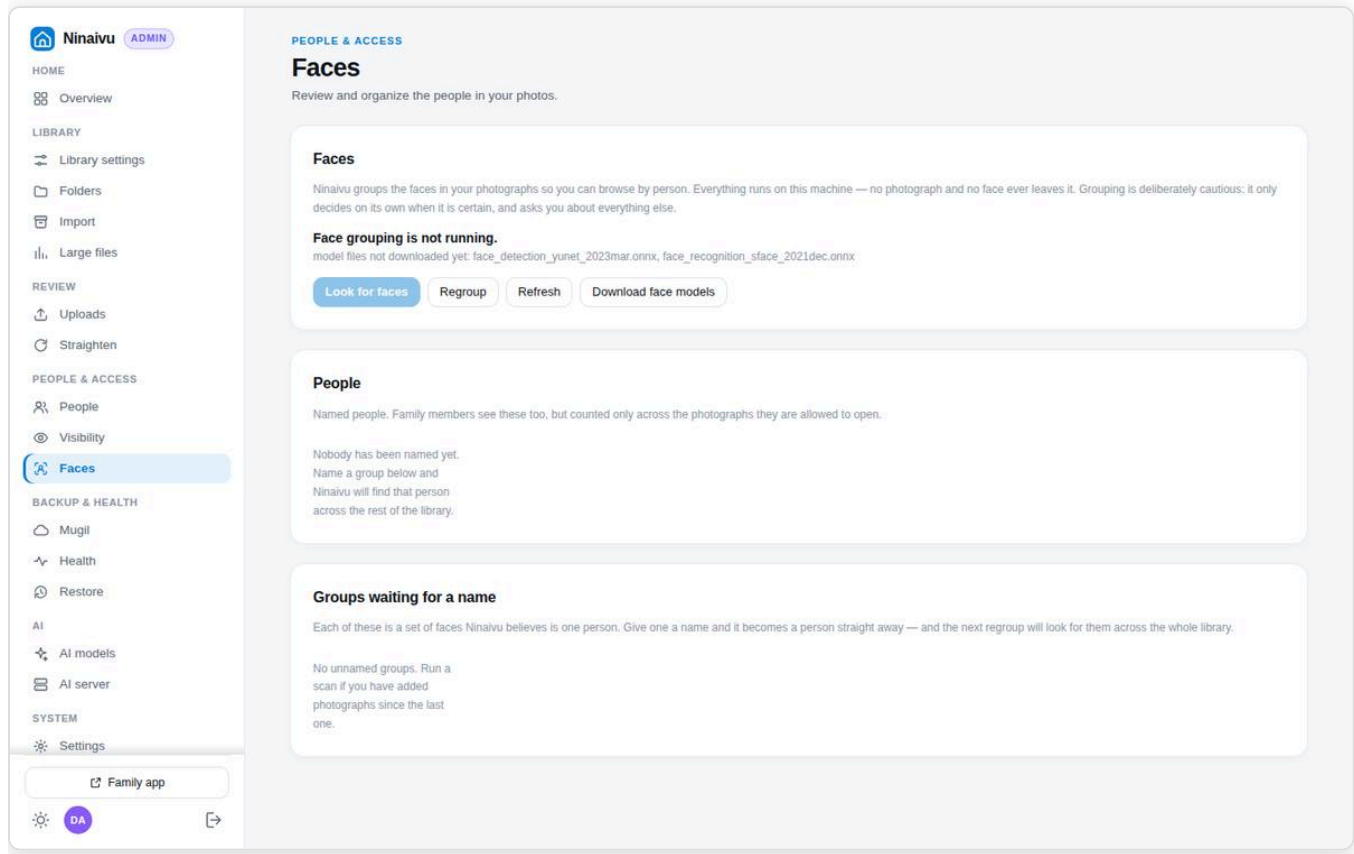
Disable is reversible and keeps the person's favourites; **delete** is final and removes the profile, its favourites and every open session. Neither touches a photograph. You cannot delete yourself or the last administrator. Disabling a profile or resetting its password ends its sessions everywhere at once.

Visibility



Who sees what. The rules for everyone come first — whether visitors may browse without signing in, whether explicit content is screened, how far back in time each role may look — and then each folder's own setting: everyone, family, or admins only. New media is *family* until somebody says otherwise, so nothing reaches a guest by accident. A folder's setting is remembered as a rule, so files scanned into it later inherit it. Setting a folder rewrites everything beneath it, so the previous state is written down first and every change can be undone in one step.

Faces



The people the face matcher found, grouped. Name one face and the rest of its group follow; groups waiting for a name are listed for a quick pass. Faces smaller than 50 pixels are skipped on purpose, which is the trade that keeps the ones it shows reliable. Names never leave the machine.

Backup & health

Mugil

The screenshot shows the Ninaivu Admin interface. On the left is a sidebar with navigation links: HOME, Overview, LIBRARY (Library settings, Folders, Import, Large files), REVIEW (Uploads, Straighten), PEOPLE & ACCESS (People, Visibility, Faces), BACKUP & HEALTH (Mugil, Health, Restore), AI (AI models, AI server), and SYSTEM (Settings). The main content area is titled 'Mugil' under the 'BACKUP & HEALTH' section. It describes Mugil as 'the encrypted copy of the library in the cloud, and how it is going.' Below this, there are two main sections: 'Mugil — cloud backup' and 'Google account'. The 'Mugil — cloud backup' section explains that a second copy of the library is kept in a Google Drive account and lists details about file uploads and deletions. The 'Google account' section provides a 'One-time setup in Google Cloud' with a list of five steps: opening console.cloud.google.com, enabling the Google Drive API, creating an OAuth client, adding a redirect URI, and pasting the client ID and secret. It includes input fields for 'Client ID' and 'Client secret', a 'Copy' button for the URI, and a 'Save' button. A 'Connect Google account' button is also present, along with a note about permissions.

Ninaivu ADMIN

HOME

Overview

LIBRARY

Library settings

Folders

Import

Large files

REVIEW

Uploads

Straighten

PEOPLE & ACCESS

People

Visibility

Faces

BACKUP & HEALTH

Mugil

Health

Restore

AI

AI models

AI server

SYSTEM

Settings

Family app

BACKUP & HEALTH

Mugil

Mugil: the encrypted copy of the library in the cloud, and how it is going.

Mugil — cloud backup

one way - Google Drive

A second copy of the library, kept in one folder in a Google Drive account you choose. It only ever goes out.

What that means, exactly

- Every file is uploaded **once**. The record of what has gone is kept here and is never cleared by anything Google does.
- Deleting a photograph in Drive does **not** delete it here, and does not cause it to be uploaded again.
- Uploading never changes or removes anything on this machine. Getting files back is a separate step, *Restore from Google Drive* below, and it never overwrites a file.
- Ninaivu works inside **one folder** it makes itself. The rest of the Drive account is not read and not touched.
- Hidden items stay here unless you say otherwise.

Google account

Needs setup

One-time setup in Google Cloud

Ninaivu cannot ship a Google client secret — a secret inside an app anybody can unzip is not a secret, and a shared one would put every household behind one quota. It is about five minutes:

1. Open console.cloud.google.com and make a project.
2. Enable the **Google Drive API** for it.
3. Under *Credentials*, create an OAuth client of type **Web application**.
4. Add this exact authorised redirect URI: <http://127.0.0.1:5602/api/cloud/callback> **Copy**
5. Paste the client ID and secret below.

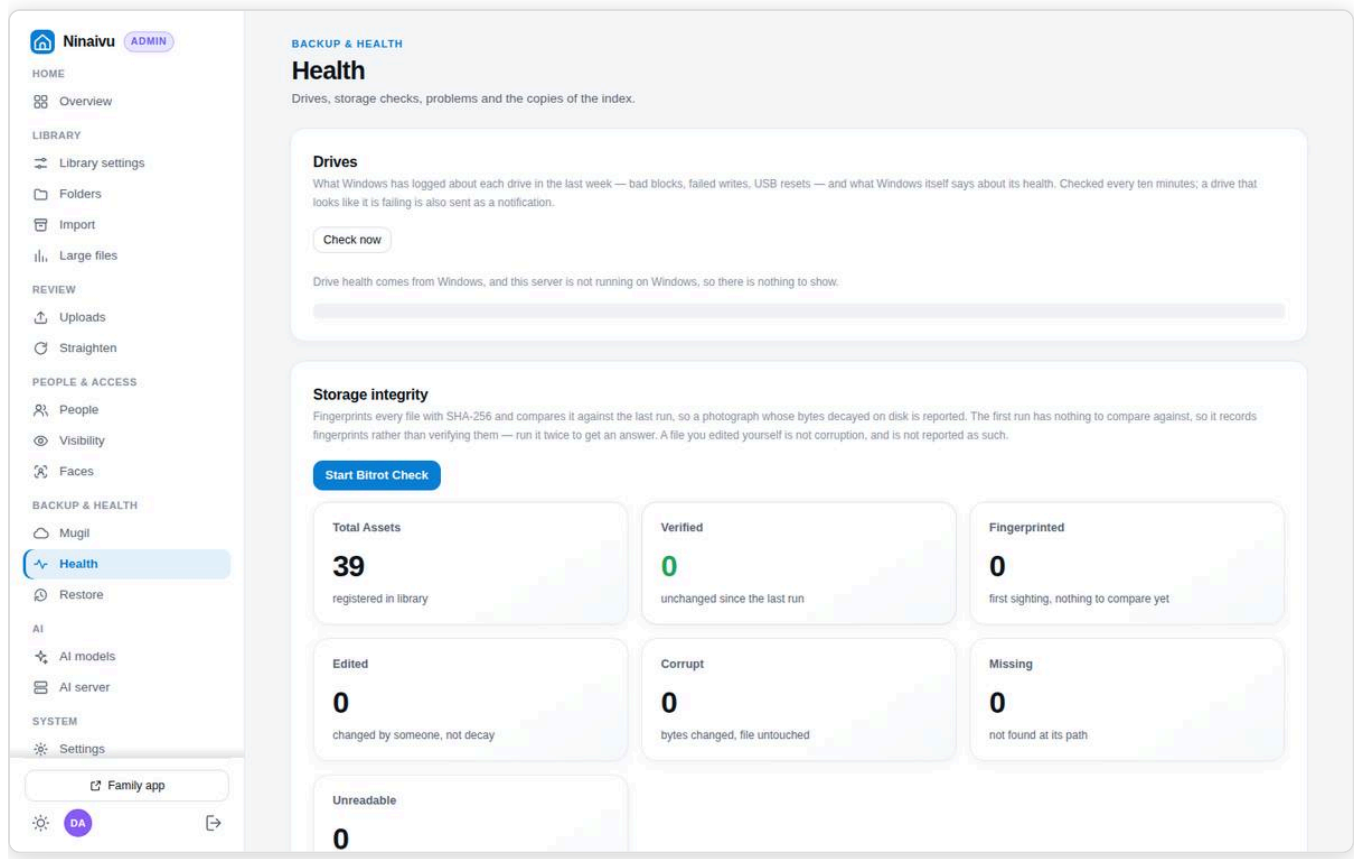
Client ID (apps.googleusercontent.com) Client secret **Save**

Connect Google account

Ninaivu asks for the narrowest permission Google offers — access to the files it creates itself, and nothing else in your Drive.

Mugil (முகில், *cloud*): the encrypted copy of the library on Google Drive — the account, what is sent and what is kept back, speed and hours, the encryption key and its recovery file, and the weekly test that the copy restores. More on backup.

Health



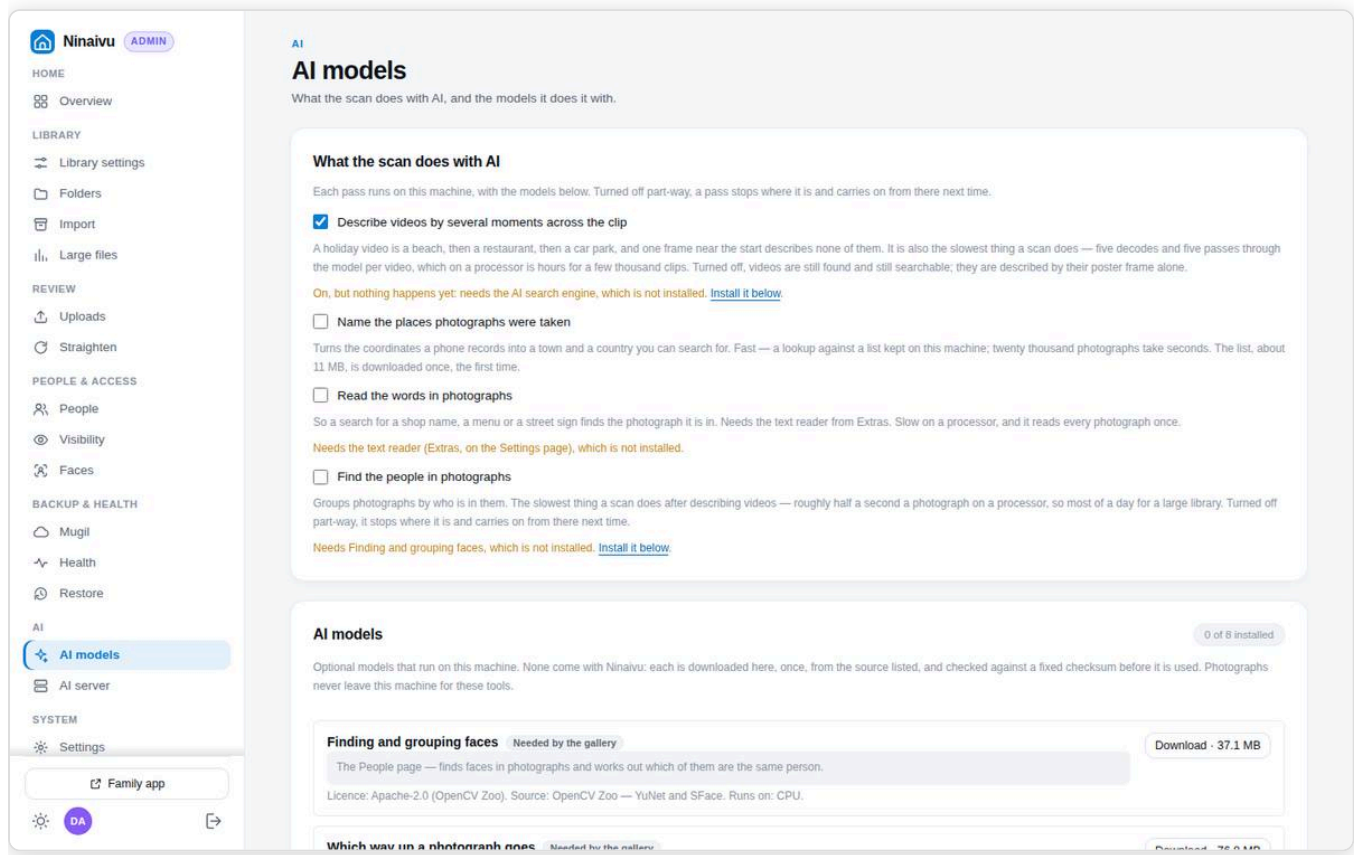
The drives and their SMART state, the storage check that reads every file back against its fingerprint, anything that went wrong since the last start, the copies of the index kept on this computer, and how the household is told when something needs them — by email or a webhook. **A photograph, once a week:** on the morning you choose, Ninaivu picks the best photograph from that day in a past year and emails it to the family; a day with nothing worth sending stays quiet.

Restore

Bringing photographs back from the cloud copy, in three steps: what to bring back, where to put it, and the encryption key. Nothing here ever overwrites a file that is already there.

AI

AI models



What the scan does with AI — naming places, reading text, finding faces, describing videos by several moments — each switch saying which model it needs and whether that model is here, then the models themselves with their downloads. Everything on this page runs on this machine. **Extensions** are switched on here too, each saying what it does when it is on. More on AI.

AI server

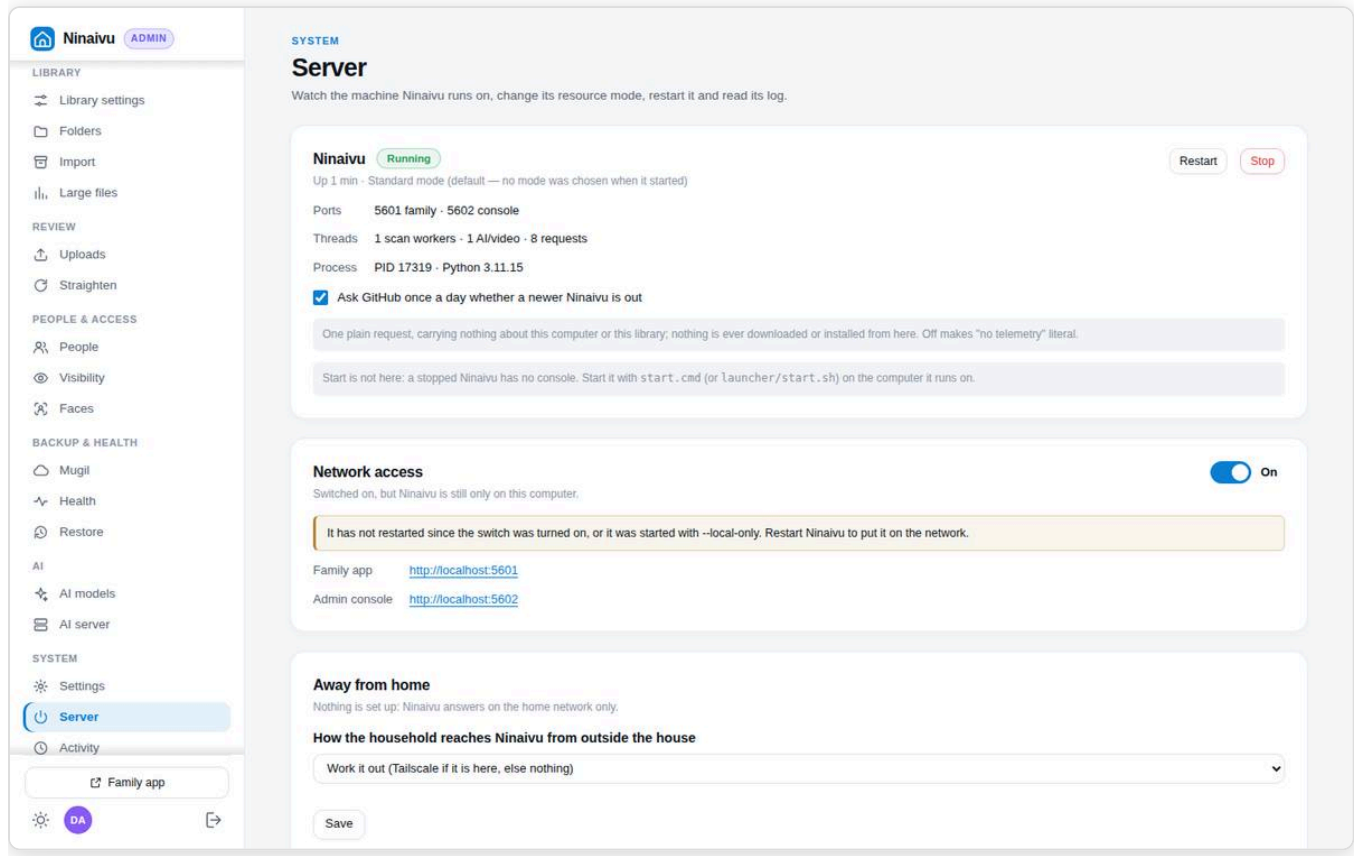
For a household with a second, stronger computer running ComfyUI: hand the heavy jobs to it. This page belongs to the Creative Studio extension and appears only while it is on.

System

Settings

This home's name, the extensions installed, the optional packages, and what is installed.

Server

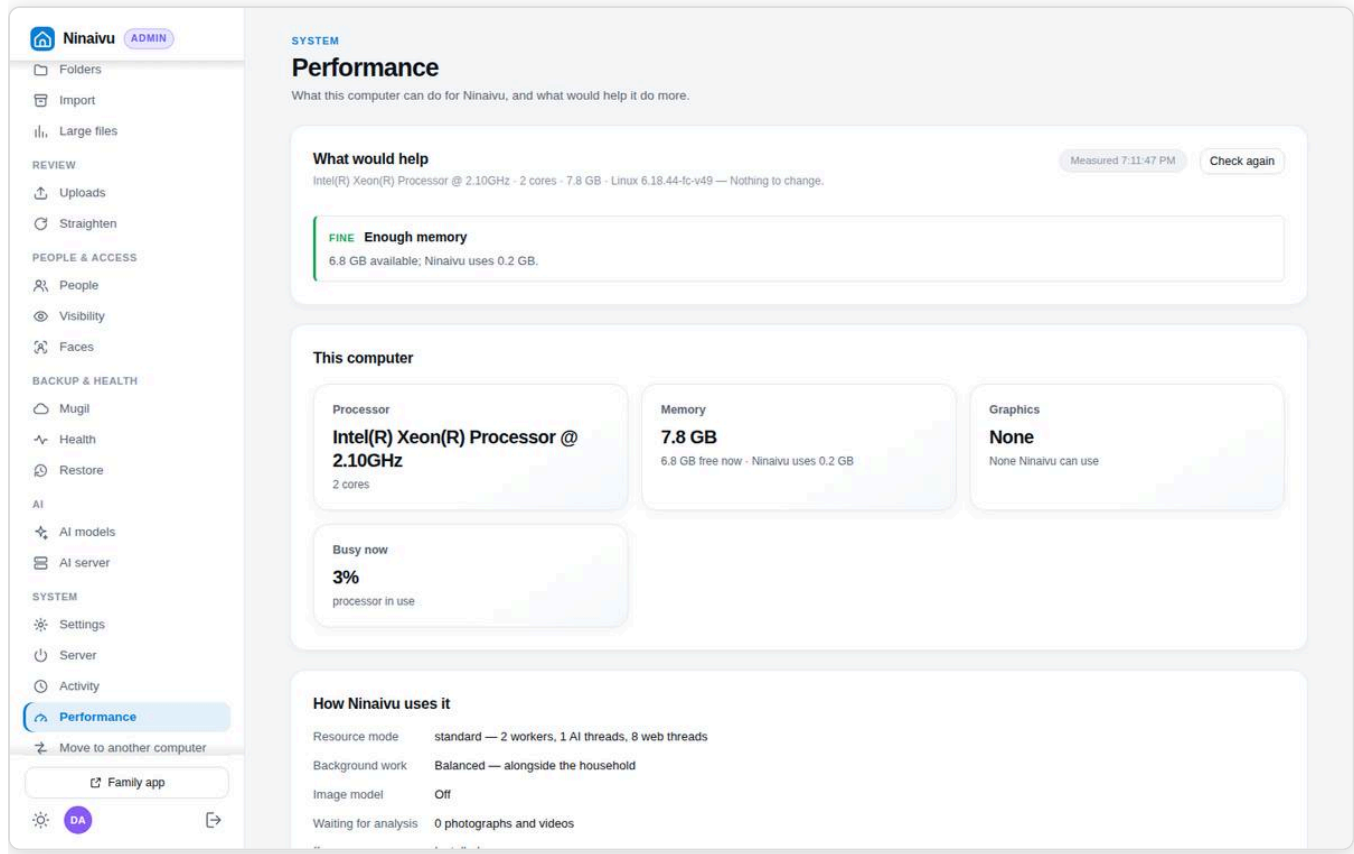


Whether Ninaivu is running and where it answers, whether a newer version is out, the addresses to give the household, **Away from home** — how the household reaches Ninaivu from outside (remote access) — the resource mode (standard, performance, power-saving), a restart, the log, and the HTTPS certificate.

Activity

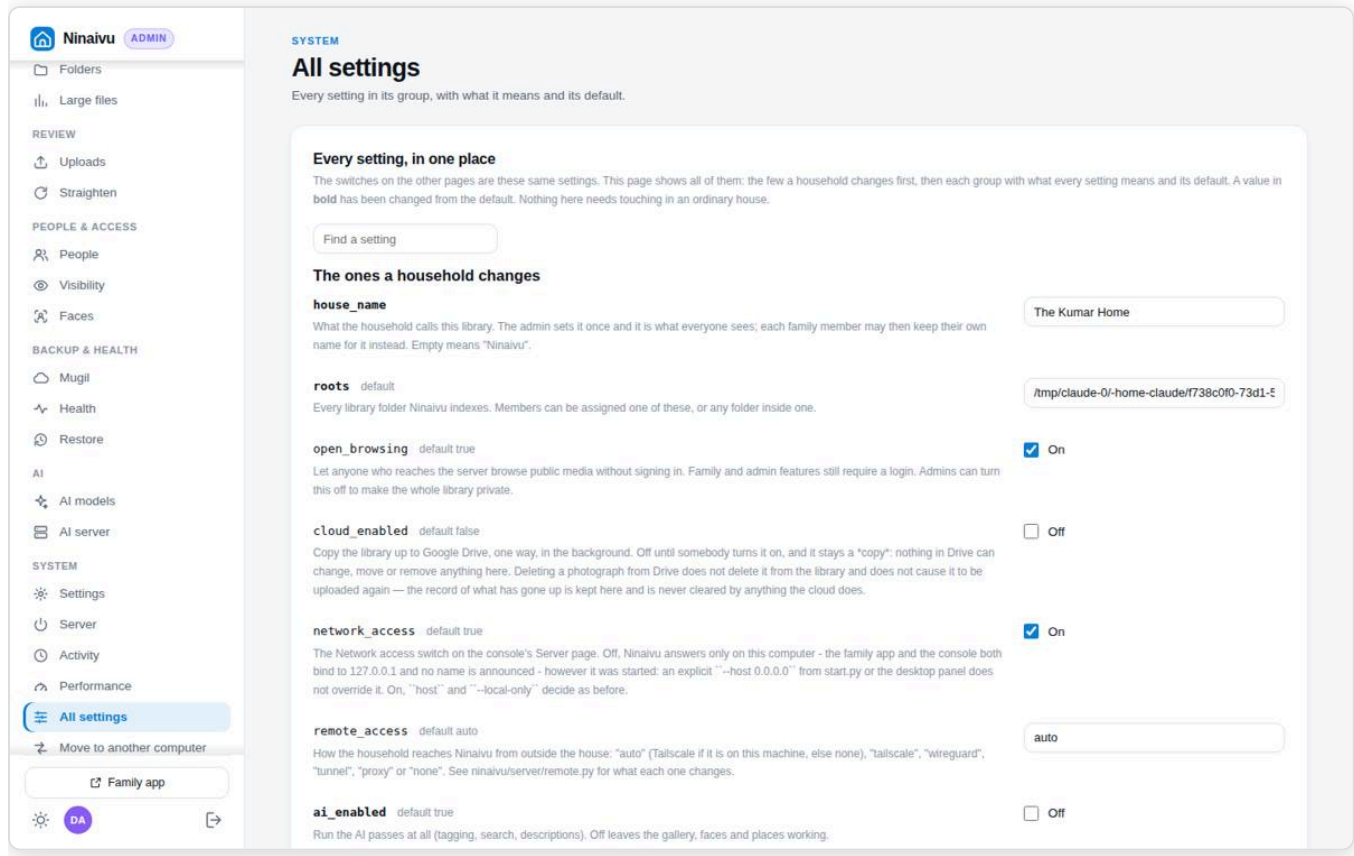
What is running now and who is using the computer, so the backup and the scans can make way for the household. **Balanced** gives way to video playback; **quiet** waits whenever anyone is using the app; **overnight** keeps the heavy work for the night hours and runs it flat out then.

Performance



What this computer can do for Ninaivu — which kind of computer it is (Basic or Full), the processor, memory, graphics, drives, how fast the last scans went, what is waiting — and what would help it do more.

All settings



Every setting Ninaivu has, in six groups, with what each means and its default. The switches on the other pages are these same settings. Nothing here needs touching in an ordinary house.

Move to another computer

Moving Ninaivu, or telling it the library has moved, without re-indexing everything. The details.

Running it from the command line

The tray and the installers start Ninaivu for you. From a checkout, `python -m ninaivu <folder>` does, and these are the flags worth knowing:

Flag

<code>--admin USER:PASSWORD</code>	make the administrator without a browser
<code>--port</code> , <code>--admin-port</code>	the two ports (80 — 443 with HTTPS — and 3000 by default)
<code>--local-only</code>	this computer only; phones cannot reach it
<code>--https</code> , <code>--cert</code> , <code>--key</code>	HTTPS with Ninaivu's own certificate, or yours
<code>--ai auto\ clip\ light\ off</code>	the image model; <i>auto</i> follows the hardware tier
<code>--faces</code> , <code>--ocr</code> , <code>--places</code>	turn the passes on from the start
<code>--no-watch</code>	do not watch the folders for changes
<code>--open-browsing</code> / <code>--private</code>	whether visitors may look without signing in
<code>--lock-roots</code>	confine the folder picker to the library folders

The settings that matter at start also read an environment variable, `NINAIVU_<NAME>` (`NINAIVU_STATE_DIR` , `NINAIVU_AI_ENGINE` , `NINAIVU_HARDWARE_TIER` , ...), and the state directory (`~/.ninaivu` , or `NINAIVU_STATE_DIR`) holds the index, the thumbnails, the models and `config.json` .